

Risk Methods — Gold Reference

Complete reference for VaR/ES, backtesting, sensitivities, P&L attribution, vol/cov estimation, stress, and capital frameworks. Anchored to the drills' verified numbers (`hist_var_drill.py`, `var_methods_drill.py`, `pnl_attribution_drill.py`).

Each entry: **(1) what it is** → **(2) how it's calculated** → **(3) formulas with I/O meaning** → **(4) toy example** → **(5) canonical Python** → **(6) pattern to remember**.

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Universal symbols

P&L	random profit-and-loss over horizon h (today $\rightarrow$ today+ h)
α	confidence level ($0.99 = 99\%$); tail mass = $1 - \alpha$
V_0	portfolio value today (the "base")
$V(\text{scenario})$	portfolio value after applying a market-state perturbation
s	sensitivity vector ($\partial V / \partial \text{factor}_i$) — DV01, CS01, vega, FX- Δ , ...
Σ	factor covariance matrix (sized $\# \text{factors} \times \# \text{factors}$)
F	matrix of historical factor changes (rows = days, cols = factors)
$z(\alpha)$	standard-normal quantile, e.g. $z(0.99) = 2.326$, $z(0.995) = 2.576$
$N(\cdot)$, $\phi(\cdot)$	std-normal CDF, PDF

Sign convention used throughout: **loss is a POSITIVE number** (VaR, ES, drawdown). P&L is negative when you lose.

DV01 convention used throughout this document: $s = V(\text{bumped}) - V(\text{base})$. Under this convention, **a long bond's DV01 is NEGATIVE** (rates up $\rightarrow$ price down $\rightarrow V_{\text{bumped}} < V_{\text{base}}$). **Bloomberg and most risk systems quote DV01 with the OPPOSITE sign** (loss-given-up; long bond DV01 is positive). If pulling a vendor DV01 into this cheatsheet's $s \cdot \Delta r$ Taylor formulae, **flip the sign**.

Horizon scaling under iid-normal returns: a 1-day VaR scales to an h -day VaR as $\text{VaR}_h = \sqrt{h} \cdot \text{VaR}_1$. This breaks under: autocorrelated returns, vol clustering (use FHS), options with non-trivial gamma over the horizon (use full-reval MC). All of FRTB IMA's per-factor liquidity-horizon (LH) scaling rests on this rule applied to **non-overlapping** horizons (§37).

Reference portfolio used in every example

Anchored to `extension_drill2.py` capstone (used by `var_methods_drill.py` and `pnl_attribution_drill.py`):

```
PF = Portfolio([
    Bond((1..5),(4,4,4,4,104),150bp),  IRS((1..5),1.0,0.042,100),
    CDS((1..5),1.0,100,120,100),      TRS(Bond,90),
    ForeignBond((1..5),(3,3,3,3,103),100,1.25),
    Swaption(2.0,(3,4,5),1.0,0.042,0.20,100),
    Repo(100,0.043,0.5), SecLending(100,20,(1,2,3),1.0), Loan(100,0.05,5,200),
    FXSpot(80,1.25), FXOption(1.0,1.30,0.12,1.25,100)])

# 250-day factor history (rate_bp, spread_bp, d_vol, fx_ret):
F[i] = [8 sin(0.3 i) + ((i%11)-5),
        5 cos(0.2 i) + ((i%7)-3),
        0.005 sin(0.4 i) + 0.001 ((i%3)-1),
        0.01 sin(0.5 i) + 0.002 ((i%5)-2)]
```

Verified reference numbers (from drills):

Metric	Value	Source
Sensitivity vector s (rate, spread, vol, fx)	(-0.51, -0.213, +5.55, +20.62) approx	<code>var_methods_drill.sensitivities()</code>
P&L std ($= \sqrt{s^T \Sigma s}$)	2.5327	drill 13
Historical VaR(99.5%)	4.6781	drill 13
Parametric VaR(99.5% / 99%)	6.5238 / 5.8919	drill 13
MC VaR(99.5% / 99%) seed=42, n=10000	6.3411 / 5.8760	drill 13
Gamma (rate, spread, vol, fx)	(1.855e-4, 4.287e-5, -1.064, 412.92)	<code>pnl_attribution_drill.gammas</code>
Explain scenario (+15bp, +10bp, +2vol, 0fx): full / first / second / unexp	-3.024 / -3.054 / +0.023 / +0.008	drill 12
5y 4% bond (single-asset hist VaR drill): base / DV01 / VaR(99.5%)	92.0706 / 0.0425 / 0.7363	<code>hist_var_drill.py</code>

Quick-jump matrix

Method	§	Pattern	Distribution assumption	Reval style
Historical VaR	1	empirical	none (data IS distribution)	FULL reval per scenario
Parametric VaR	2	analytical	factors ~ MV-normal, book LINEAR	sensitivity-based
Monte Carlo VaR	3	simulated	factors ~ assumed (e.g. MV-normal)	FULL reval per path
Expected Shortfall	4	mean of tail	inherits from method	inherits
Filtered Historical	5	empirical, rescaled	GARCH on factors	FULL reval
Cornish-Fisher	6	analytical	normal + skew/kurt adj	sensitivity-based
Marginal/Component VaR	7	analytical	normal	gradient of σ
Stressed VaR	8	historical, fixed window	"12-month stress period"	FULL reval
Kupiec / Christoffersen	9-10	LR test on hit-sequence	—	—
Basel traffic light	11	hit-count over 250 days	—	—

Part 0 — The Master Recipe

Every risk number in this document is a special case of **one identity**:

$$\text{risk_number} = T(\text{distribution}(\text{P\&L}))$$

where T is a tail functional — $T = \text{quantile}$ gives **VaR**, $T = \text{mean} \mid \text{loss} > \text{VaR}$ gives **ES**, $T = \text{sum of } |\text{hits}|/N$ gives a **backtest**.

The three things you ever change are: 1. **How you generate the P&L distribution** (history / parametric / MC). 2. **How you revalue** the book (sensitivity-based vs full reval). 3. **What functional T** you compute (quantile, mean-of-tail, gradient, scenario sum).

Everything else is bookkeeping.

The 4-step risk recipe

STEP 1. IDENTIFY FACTORS.

What random variables drive your P&L? (yield curve, credit spread, vol, FX, equity, commodity). Bucket where appropriate (KRD per tenor).

STEP 2. GENERATE SHOCKS.

Three choices:

- (a) HISTORICAL — replay actual daily factor moves (last 250d).
- (b) PARAMETRIC — assume MV-normal with covariance Σ ; quantile = $z \cdot \sigma$.
- (c) SIMULATED — Cholesky $\Sigma \rightarrow$ draw Gaussian (or other) paths.

STEP 3. REVALUE.

Two choices:

- (i) SENSITIVITY-BASED — $\text{P\&L} \approx s \cdot \text{shock}$ (Taylor, fast, linear).
- (ii) FULL REVALUATION — $\text{P\&L} = V(\text{shocked}) - V(\text{base})$ (slow, exact).

STEP 4. AGGREGATE / EXTRACT.

$T(\text{distribution})$: quantile for VaR, mean-of-tail for ES, gradient for marginal VaR, sum for scenario explain.

That's it. The whole field of market-risk methodology is which option you pick in steps 2 and 3.

The substitution table

Method	Step 2 (shocks)	Step 3 (reval)	Step 4 (T)	Trade-off
Historical VaR	actual factor history F	FULL reval per row	quantile	no distribution assumption; bounded by window
Parametric VaR	implied: $\sigma_{\text{P\&L}} = \sqrt{s^T \Sigma s}$	sensitivity (linear)	$z(\alpha) \cdot \sigma$	fast; assumes normal + linear; misses fat tails + gamma
Monte Carlo VaR	$L \cdot z$, $L = \text{chol}(\Sigma)$, $z \sim N(0, I)$	FULL reval per path	quantile	captures non-linearity; model-dependent; heavy
Expected Shortfall	inherits	inherits	mean of P&L $\leq -\text{VaR}$	coherent (subadditive); FRTB standard
Filtered Historical	F rescaled by GARCH σ ratio	FULL reval	quantile	history + vol updating; handles vol clustering
Cornish-Fisher	parametric + sample (skew, kurt)	sensitivity (linear)	adjusted quantile	quick fat-tail fix without MC

Method	Step 2 (shocks)	Step 3 (reval)	Step 4 (T)	Trade-off
Marginal/Component	parametric	sensitivity	gradient of $\sigma_{P\&L}$	risk decomposition by position
Stressed VaR	history from a fixed 12M stress window	FULL reval	quantile	locked-in stress; doesn't drift with calm markets

Three worked walk-throughs of the recipe

Walk-through 1 — Historical VaR

```

STEP 1. Factors: 4 (rate, spread, vol, fx). History F: 250 × 4.
STEP 2. Shocks = each row of F (replay actual daily moves).
STEP 3. For each row i: V_i = pf.value(scenario(*F[i]).apply(base)); P&L_i = V_i - V_0.
STEP 4. Sort P&L ascending; VaR(α) = -P&L[floor((1-α)·N)].
        At α=0.995, N=250: index 1 (second worst) → VaR = 4.6781.

```

That IS the Historical VaR formula in §1.

Walk-through 2 — Parametric VaR

```

STEP 1. Same 4 factors.
STEP 2. Σ = cov(F) (4×4). No path generation.
STEP 3. Sensitivity vector s = (∂V/∂rate_bp, ∂V/∂spread_bp, ∂V/∂vol/0.01, ∂V/∂fx/0.01).
        Taylor: ΔV ≈ s · Δfactor.
        Distribution of ΔV: zero-mean Normal with std σ = √(sᵀΣs) = 2.5327.
STEP 4. VaR(α) = z(α) · σ. At α=0.995: 2.576 · 2.5327 = 6.5238.

```

Walk-through 3 — Monte Carlo VaR

```

STEP 1. Same factors.
STEP 2. L = chol(Σ); draws ~ N(0, I)_{n × 4}; shocks = draws @ L.T ~ N(0, Σ).
STEP 3. For each path k: P&L_k = V(scenario(*shocks[k]).apply(base)) - V_0
        (FULL revaluation - captures gamma).
STEP 4. VaR(α) = -percentile(P&L, (1-α)·100).
        At α=0.995, seed=42, n=10000: 6.3411.

```

Three recipes, three numbers, **one pattern**. The 6.34 (MC) vs 6.52 (param) gap is the **non-linearity correction** (full reval picks up convexity the linear Taylor misses). The 4.68 (hist) being LOWER than both is the **bounded-history correction** (the actual 250-day window's tail is thinner than a normal calibrated on the same covariance — the data simply hasn't seen as bad a day).

When the recipe breaks (flag and look up)

Situation	Why simple recipe fails	What to add
Heavy tails (fat-tailed factors)	normal underestimates extreme losses	Cornish-Fisher / EVT / t-copula MC
Vol clustering (GARCH effects)	recent vol > historical vol	Filtered Historical Sim (rescale by GARCH σ)
Non-linear book (lots of options)	linear approx misses gamma, vega-gamma	Full-reval MC (drop parametric)

Situation	Why simple recipe fails	What to add
Path-dependent products (barriers, MBS)	single shock can't reveal path	path-dependent MC
Wrong-way risk (CCR)	exposure ↑ when counterparty quality ↓	CVA with explicit correlation
Liquidity-adjusted	liquidation can't happen in 1 day	LVaR (add liquidation cost / horizon scaling)

The 3 patterns to recognise

- P1 SENSITIVITY-BASED: $\text{risk} \approx s \cdot \text{shock}$ (or $\sqrt{s^T \Sigma s}$ for portfolios)
 Used by: parametric VaR, marginal VaR, Cornish-Fisher, FRTB SA.
 Fast $O(\text{\#factors})$; falls down on non-linearity.
- P2 FULL-REVALUATION: $\text{risk} = T(V(\text{shocked}) - V(\text{base}) \text{ over many shocks })$
 Used by: historical VaR, MC VaR, stress P&L, ES (full-reval flavour).
 Exact; cost = $O(\text{\#paths} \times \text{pricer_cost})$.
- P3 EMPIRICAL DISTRIBUTION: $\text{risk} = T(\text{empirical_pnl_vector})$
 Used by: historical VaR, FHS, backtests.
 No distribution assumption; bounded by window length.

Every method below is a combination. **Parametric** = P1 + analytical Normal. **Historical** = P2 + P3. **MC** = P2 + simulated Normal/copula. **Filtered Historical** = P2 + P3 + GARCH rescale.

Part I — VaR & Expected Shortfall

1. Historical VaR

TL;DR: Rank-order actual daily P&Ls; report the $(1-\alpha)$ -quantile loss. No distribution assumption; bounded by window.

What: rank-order the **actual** historical daily P&Ls and report the loss at the $(1-\alpha)$ quantile. No distributional assumption — the data IS the distribution.

How it's calculated:

1. Take last N days of risk-factor changes: $F[i]$ for $i = 0..N-1$
2. For each day i : shock today's market by $F[i]$, revalue $\rightarrow P\&L_i = V_i - V_0$
3. Sort P&L ascending
4. $VaR(\alpha) = -P\&L[\text{floor}((1-\alpha) \cdot N)]$

Formula:

$$VaR(\alpha) = -\text{sorted}(P\&L)[\lfloor (1-\alpha) \cdot N \rfloor]$$

Input	Meaning
N	history window length (typically 250 trading days = 1 year)
α	confidence (0.99, 0.995)
$P\&L_i$	full-reval P&L on scenario $i = V(F[i] \text{ applied}) - V_0$

Toy example (single-asset, `hist_var_drill.py`):

```
5y 4% bond, notional 100, spread 150bp
N = 250 days; factor shocks d_rate_bp[i], d_spread_bp[i]

base price = 92.0706
P&L_i = bond_price(rate_bump=d_rate_bp[i], spread_bp=150+d_spread_bp[i]) - 92.0706
min / max(P&L) = -0.8011 / +0.8504

sorted P&L: index 0 = worst loss (P&L most negative)
VaR(99.5%) = -sorted[1] = 0.7363
VaR(99.0%) = -sorted[2] = 0.7033
```

Canonical Python:

```
import numpy as np

def historical_var(pnl: np.ndarray, conf: float = 0.99) -> float:
    """Historical VaR via percentile. pnl is a vector of N P&Ls (loss = negative)."""
    return -np.percentile(pnl, (1 - conf) * 100)

# Equivalent index-based form (matches Solvency II SCR calibration):
def historical_var_idx(pnl: np.ndarray, conf: float = 0.995) -> float:
    s = np.sort(pnl) # ascending: most negative first
    idx = int(np.floor((1 - conf) * len(pnl)))
    return -s[idx]
```

Intuition / pattern: P3 — empirical. Bounded by window: anything not in your 250 days literally cannot show up. A book that hasn't seen a 2008 will print a tiny VaR until the day after one happens.

Limits: - Static window $\rightarrow$ vol clustering missed (today's calm hides yesterday's storm and vice versa). - 250 days at $\alpha=0.995$ means the answer is **literally the 2nd-worst day** $\rightarrow$ enormous sampling error in the

tail; rolling-window VaR jumps when a single bad day enters/leaves. - Fix: **Filtered Historical** (§5) rescales each historical shock by the ratio $\sigma_{\text{today}} / \sigma_{\text{then}}$.

2. Parametric (delta-normal) VaR

TL;DR: $\text{VaR} = z(\alpha) \cdot \sqrt{s^T \Sigma s}$. Closed-form, assumes joint-normal factors AND linear book.

What: assume factor changes are joint-normal with covariance Σ , and the book is **linear** in factors (sensitivities are constant). Then P&L is normal with std $\sigma = \sqrt{s^T \Sigma s}$ and the quantile is closed-form.

How it's calculated:

1. Compute sensitivity vector $s = (\partial V / \partial f_i)_i$ (one bump per factor)
2. Estimate factor covariance $\Sigma = \text{cov}(F)$
3. P&L std: $\sigma = \sqrt{s^T \Sigma s}$
4. $\text{VaR}(\alpha) = z(\alpha) \cdot \sigma$ where $z = \text{norm.ppf}$

Formula:

$$\begin{aligned}\sigma^2_{\text{P\&L}} &= s^T \Sigma s \\ \text{VaR}(\alpha) &= z(\alpha) \cdot \sigma_{\text{P\&L}}\end{aligned}$$

Input	Meaning
s	row vector of first-order sensitivities, one entry per factor
Σ	factor covariance matrix; same units as s 's shock unit
$z(\alpha)$	std-normal quantile — $\text{norm.ppf}(\alpha)$; 99% $\rightarrow$ 2.326, 99.5% $\rightarrow$ 2.576

Toy example (`var_methods_drill.py`):

```
s = [ ∂V/∂rate_bp, ∂V/∂spread_bp, ∂V/∂vol/0.01, ∂V/∂fx/0.01 ]
Σ = cov(F)      (4×4; F = 250×4 factor history)

σ_P&L      = √(sT Σ s)      = 2.5327
VaR(99.5%) = 2.576 · 2.5327 = 6.5238
VaR(99.0%) = 2.326 · 2.5327 = 5.8919
```

Canonical Python:

```
import numpy as np
from scipy.stats import norm

def parametric_var(s: np.ndarray, cov: np.ndarray, conf: float = 0.99) -> float:
    """Delta-normal VaR. s: sensitivity vector. cov: factor covariance (same shock units)."""
    pnl_var = float(s @ cov @ s)
    pnl_std = np.sqrt(pnl_var)
    return norm.ppf(conf) * pnl_std

# Toy: 1 rate factor (DV01=100 per bp), 1 FX factor (FX-Δ=50 per 1.0)
s = np.array([100.0, 50.0])
cov = np.diag([(8.0)**2, (0.005)**2]) # bp2 and unit2 – factor units MUST match s
print(parametric_var(s, cov, 0.99)) # → 1862.5 ($)
```

Intuition / pattern: P1 — sensitivity-based, analytical Normal. Closed-form, scales $O(\text{\#factors}^2)$ regardless of book size. The cost is a **double assumption**: factors normal AND book linear. Two errors that can cancel or compound:

- Skew/heavy tails $\rightarrow$ Normal underestimates $\rightarrow$ VaR too LOW.
- Positive gamma (long options) $\rightarrow$ linear underestimates payoff $\rightarrow$ VaR too HIGH.
- Negative gamma (short options) $\rightarrow$ linear overestimates payoff $\rightarrow$ VaR too LOW.

When it works: a vanilla rates/credit book with no concentrated optionality. When in doubt, do MC + compare.

3. Monte Carlo VaR (full revaluation)

TL;DR: Cholesky-simulate factor paths; full-revalue book per path; take percentile. Only method that handles non-linearity + arbitrary distribution.

What: simulate factor paths under an assumed joint distribution (typically MV-normal via Cholesky), then full-revalue the book on each path and take the empirical quantile.

How it's calculated:

```
1.  $\Sigma$  = factor covariance
2.  $L = \text{cholesky}(\Sigma)$  (lower-triangular,  $L L^T = \Sigma$ )
3. Draw  $z \sim N(0, I)_{\{n \times \text{\#factors}\}}$ 
4.  $\text{shocks} = z @ L^T$  ( $\sim N(0, \Sigma)$  jointly normal)
5. For each path  $k$ :  $P\&L_k = V(\text{scenario}(*\text{shocks}[k]).\text{apply}(\text{base})) - V_0$  (FULL reval)
6.  $\text{VaR}(\alpha) = -\text{percentile}(P\&L, (1-\alpha) \cdot 100)$ 
```

Formula:

```
 $L L^T = \Sigma$ ;  $\text{shocks} = z \cdot L^T \sim N(0, \Sigma)$ 
 $P\&L_k = V_{\text{full\_reval}}(\text{base} + \text{shocks}_k) - V_0$ 
 $\text{VaR}(\alpha) = -\text{quantile}(P\&L, 1-\alpha)$ 
```

Input	Meaning
n	number of MC paths (10,000 typical; 100,000 for tail accuracy)
seed	RNG seed — always set explicitly for reproducible risk numbers
Σ	factor covariance (units must match the pricer's shock interface)

Toy example (`var_methods_drill.py`):

```
Same  $s$ ,  $\Sigma$  as parametric.
n_paths = 10_000, seed = 42
VaR(99.5%) = 6.3411 ← LOWER than parametric 6.5238 (gamma cushions losses)
VaR(99.0%) = 5.8760 ← almost identical to parametric 5.8919 at 99%
```

The 99% match shows the book is mostly linear; the 99.5% gap reveals the tail non-linearity that parametric ignores.

Canonical Python:

```
import numpy as np

def monte_carlo_var(value_fn, base, cov: np.ndarray,
                    conf: float = 0.99, n_paths: int = 10_000, seed: int = 42) -> float:
    """Cholesky MC VaR with FULL revaluation. value_fn(base, shocks_row) -> V.
    cov shape: (#factors, #factors); units must match value_fn's expected shock vector.
    """
    L = np.linalg.cholesky(cov)
    rng = np.random.default_rng(seed)
    z = rng.standard_normal((n_paths, cov.shape[0]))
    shocks = z @ L.T # ~ N(0, Σ)
    v0 = value_fn(base, np.zeros(cov.shape[0]))
    pnl = np.array([value_fn(base, s) - v0 for s in shocks])
    return float(-np.percentile(pnl, (1 - conf) * 100))
```

Intuition / pattern: P2 + simulated distribution. The only method that combines **(a) distributional flexibility** (swap $N(0, \Sigma)$ for t-copula, NIG, GARCH-Cholesky, ...) and **(b) full revaluation** (captures

gamma, vega-gamma, cross-gamma). Cost is $n_paths \times pricer_cost$ — for slow pricers (MBS, Bermudan), this can run for hours.

Variance reduction: antithetic variates, control variates, importance sampling, quasi-Monte Carlo (Sobol). Cuts standard error of the quantile estimator.

4. Expected Shortfall (CVaR)

TL;DR: Average loss IN the tail, not at the tail boundary. Coherent (subadditive); FRTB standard at $\alpha=0.975$.

What: the **average loss given you are in the tail**. $ES_\alpha = E[L \mid L \geq VaR_\alpha]$. Replaces VaR under FRTB IMA because it is **coherent** (subadditive — diversifying always helps).

How it's calculated:

1. Generate the P&L distribution (any of §1–3).
2. Find $VaR_\alpha = -\text{quantile}(P\&L, 1-\alpha)$.
3. $ES_\alpha = -\text{mean}(P\&L \mid P\&L \leq -VaR_\alpha)$
= - mean(P&Ls in the worst $(1-\alpha)$ fraction)

Formula:

$$ES_\alpha = E[-P\&L \mid P\&L \leq -VaR_\alpha]$$

Empirical: $ES_\alpha = -\text{mean}(\text{sorted_pnl}[:k])$
 $k = \lceil (1-\alpha) \cdot N \rceil$

Parametric (Normal) closed-form:

$$ES_\alpha = \sigma \cdot \varphi(z(\alpha)) / (1 - \alpha) \quad (\text{zero-mean P\&L})$$

At $\alpha = 0.975$: $ES = \sigma \cdot 2.338$ (FRTB calibration)
At $\alpha = 0.99$: $ES = \sigma \cdot 2.665$

Toy example (same drill 13 portfolio, parametric Normal):

```
 $\sigma = 2.5327$   
 $ES(97.5\%) \text{ parametric} = 2.5327 \cdot \varphi(1.96)/0.025 = 2.5327 \cdot 2.3378 = 5.9220$   
 $ES(99\%) \text{ parametric} = 2.5327 \cdot \varphi(2.326)/0.01 = 2.5327 \cdot 2.6652 = 6.7501$   
(Compare  $VaR(99\%) = 5.89$ ;  $ES(97.5\%)$  is FRTB's "10-day liquidity-horizon-scaled" replacement.)
```

Canonical Python:

```
import numpy as np
from scipy.stats import norm

def historical_es(pnl: np.ndarray, conf: float = 0.975) -> float:
    """Empirical ES: average loss in the worst (1-conf) fraction."""
    s = np.sort(pnl)
    k = max(1, int(np.ceil((1 - conf) * len(pnl))))
    return float(-s[k:].mean())

def parametric_es(sigma: float, conf: float = 0.975) -> float:
    """Normal-distribution ES (zero-mean P&L), closed-form."""
    z = norm.ppf(conf)
    return float(sigma * norm.pdf(z) / (1 - conf))
```

Intuition / pattern: ES sums the WHOLE tail, not just the boundary. **Coherent:** $ES(A+B) \leq ES(A) + ES(B)$ always (VaR can violate this for non-elliptical distributions, especially long-tail credit). FRTB IMA uses $ES(97.5\%)$ on a stressed window with liquidity-horizon scaling per factor class.

Key relation (Normal):

```
ES_α(Normal) / VaR_α(Normal) ≈ φ(z(α)) / [(1-α)·z(α)]  
At α=0.99: ratio ≈ 1.145 → ES is ~14.5% bigger than VaR for normal P&L  
At α=0.975: ratio ≈ 1.193
```

5. Filtered Historical Simulation (FHS)

TL;DR: Historical VaR with each old shock rescaled by today's GARCH vol. Solves stale-vol problem in calm/crisis transitions.

What: historical simulation, but each old shock is **rescaled** by the ratio of today's volatility to the volatility on the day the shock happened. Combines history's empirical distribution with GARCH's vol updating.

How it's calculated:

1. Estimate a GARCH(1,1) on each factor: $\hat{\sigma}_t = \sqrt{(\omega + \alpha \cdot r_{t-1}^2 + \beta \cdot \sigma_{t-1}^2)}$
2. Standardise historical innovations: $z_i = F_i / \hat{\sigma}_i$ (per factor)
3. Rescale by today's vol: $\text{shock}_i = \hat{\sigma}_{\text{today}} \cdot z_i$
4. Apply each rescaled shock, full-reval, VaR as in §1.

Formula:

```
shock_i_today = ( $\hat{\sigma}_{\text{today}}$  /  $\hat{\sigma}_{i_{\text{then}}}$ ) · F_i  
then proceed as historical VaR
```

Toy example:

History contains a calm period ($\hat{\sigma} = 0.5\%$) and the current state is vol-stressed ($\hat{\sigma} = 2\%$).
A historical move of 10bp on a calm day → rescaled to $(2.0/0.5) \cdot 10 = 40\text{bp}$ today.
Tail VaR rises commensurately even though the "shock library" is the same 250 days.

Canonical Python (sketch — full GARCH fit usually via `arch` library):

```
import numpy as np  
from arch import arch_model # uv add arch  
  
def fhs_shocks(returns_history: np.ndarray) -> np.ndarray:  
    """Rescale a 1-factor history by today's GARCH(1,1) vol."""  
    am = arch_model(returns_history * 100, mean="Zero", vol="GARCH", p=1, q=1)  
    res = am.fit(dispatch="off")  
    sigma_t = res.conditional_volatility / 100 # per-day estimated σ  
    z = returns_history / sigma_t # standardised innovations  
    sigma_today = sigma_t[-1]  
    return sigma_today * z # rescaled shock library
```

Intuition / pattern: P2 + P3 + GARCH rescale. Solves historical's "stale during crises" problem without giving up the empirical distribution. Standard for trading-desk VaR on liquid factors (FX, rates).

Limits: if the GARCH model is mis-specified (regime shift, structural break), the rescale is wrong. Always plot $\hat{\sigma}_t$ against realised vol as a sanity check.

5b. FHS — bootstrap variant (production form)

TL;DR: Draw standardised residuals with replacement (instead of rescaling each day). What most production desks actually run.

What: most production desks don't simply *rescale* each historical day. They **bootstrap** standardised residuals — draw z^* with replacement from the empirical innovation distribution, then scale by today's

GARCH σ . Captures both **vol updating** (from GARCH) and **distributional shape** (from history, including its fat tails).

How it's calculated:

1. Fit GARCH(1,1) on each factor; extract standardised residuals $z_i = r_i / \hat{\sigma}_i$.
2. For each of n_{paths} simulated days:
draw z^* with replacement from $\{z_1, \dots, z_T\}$ # empirical bootstrap
shock_path = $\hat{\sigma}_{\text{today}} \cdot z^*$
3. Apply each shock, full-reval $\rightarrow$ P&L distribution.
4. $\text{VaR}(\alpha) = -\text{percentile}(\text{P\&L}, (1-\alpha) \cdot 100)$ as usual.

Formula:

```
z* ~ Empirical({r_i / σ̂_i}) (with replacement)
shock = σ̂_today · z*
Then standard FULL-reval Historical VaR pipeline.
```

Toy example:

```
History 250 days, GARCH σ̂_today = 1.5%. Standardised residuals z = r/σ̂ have:
empirical std = 1.0 (by construction)
empirical skew = -0.4 (negative-tail fatter)
empirical kurt = 5.2 (excess; Normal would be 0)

n_paths = 10_000: draw 10k z* values with replacement; shock = 1.5% · z*.
Resulting tail at 99% is fatter than parametric σ̂ · z(0.99) because the BOOTSTRAP
preserves the empirical kurt, not just the variance.
```

Canonical Python:

```
import numpy as np

def fhs_bootstrap_shocks(returns_history: np.ndarray, sigma_today: float,
                        n_paths: int = 10_000, seed: int = 42) -> np.ndarray:
    """FHS via bootstrap of standardised residuals.
    Requires a fitted σ̂_t history (use GARCH or EWMA – passed in implicitly via
    standardised residuals z_i = r_i / σ̂_i)."""
    rng = np.random.default_rng(seed)
    # Assume returns_history is already standardised by σ̂_t per-day:
    z_star = rng.choice(returns_history, size=n_paths, replace=True)
    return sigma_today * z_star
```

Intuition / pattern: GARCH for the SCALE, empirical for the SHAPE. Solves both: (a) regime-aware vol from GARCH, (b) fat tails / skew from history — without the parametric assumption fight. Standard for FX, rates, equity-index VaR engines at most major banks.

Variant: Christoffersen-Diebold filter instead of GARCH (kernel-smoothed) — same idea, smoother $\hat{\sigma}_t$.

6. Cornish-Fisher VaR

TL;DR: Adjust Normal quantile by sample skew + excess kurt. Quick fat-tail fix without MC; fails for very heavy tails.

What: a fat-tail correction to parametric VaR that adjusts the Gaussian quantile by the **sample skew and kurtosis**. One line of arithmetic; no MC.

How it's calculated:

1. Compute sample mean μ , std σ , skew S , excess kurtosis K of returns.
2. Cornish-Fisher quantile:

$$z_{CF}(\alpha) = z + (z^2 - 1) \cdot S/6 + (z^3 - 3z) \cdot K/24 - (2z^3 - 5z) \cdot S^2/36$$
3. $VaR(\alpha) = -(\mu + z_{CF} \cdot \sigma)$ (z is the standard-Normal quantile of $1-\alpha$; negative for tails)

Formula (the corrected quantile):

$$z_{CF}(\alpha) = z + (z^2 - 1) \cdot S/6 + (z^3 - 3z) \cdot K/24 - (2z^3 - 5z) \cdot S^2/36$$

$$VaR(\alpha) = -(\mu + z_{CF} \cdot \sigma)$$

Input	Meaning
z	std-Normal quantile of $1-\alpha$ (negative for tails — e.g. -2.326 for 99%)
S	sample skew of returns (negative S = downside-heavy tail)
K	sample EXCESS kurtosis (= kurt - 3; positive for fat tails)

Toy example:

Sample equity returns: $\mu=0$, $\sigma=0.012$, skew $S=-0.5$, excess kurt $K=4$.
 At $\alpha=0.99$: $z = -2.326$.
 $z_{CF} = -2.326 + (5.41-1)(-0.5)/6 + (-12.58+6.98)(4)/24 - (-25.16+11.63)(0.25)/36$
 $= -2.326 - 0.367 - 0.933 + 0.094$
 ≈ -3.532
 $VaR_{99} = 0.012 \cdot 3.532 = 4.24\%$ (vs Normal $VaR_{99} = 0.012 \cdot 2.326 = 2.79\%$)

The fat-tail correction here makes VaR ~50% larger than the Gaussian assumption.

Canonical Python:

```
import numpy as np
from scipy.stats import norm, skew, kurtosis

def cornish_fisher_var(returns: np.ndarray, conf: float = 0.99) -> float:
    mu, sd = returns.mean(), returns.std(ddof=1)
    S = skew(returns)
    K = kurtosis(returns) # already excess (Fisher def)
    z = norm.ppf(1 - conf) # negative for tail
    z_cf = z + (z**2 - 1)*S/6 + (z**3 - 3*z)*K/24 - (2*z**3 - 5*z)*S**2/36
    return float(-(mu + z_cf * sd))
```

Intuition / pattern: P1 + parametric with moment corrections. Cheap fat-tail fix when MC is too expensive but Normal is too thin. Falls apart for very heavy tails ($|S|>2$ or $K>10$) — at that point use EVT or t-copula MC.

7. Marginal / Component / Incremental VaR

TL;DR: MVAR = per-\$ trade sizing; CVAR = limit attribution (Σ = total VaR via Euler); IVAR = full-removal what-if.

What: decomposes total VaR by position. Three flavours, three different questions:

- **Marginal VaR (MVAR_i):** per-\$ sensitivity — $\partial VaR / \partial w_i$. "What's the risk per extra dollar in position i ?"
- **Component VaR (CVAR_i):** contribution to total — $w_i \cdot MVAR_i$. **Sums to total VaR.**
- **Incremental VaR (IVAR_i):** full removal — $VaR(\text{portfolio}) - VaR(\text{portfolio without position } i)$. The actual "what if I close this position".

How it's calculated (under MV-normal):

$\sigma^2_{P\&L} = w^T \Sigma w$	(w = position vector, Σ = position cov)
$MVaR_i = z(\alpha) \cdot (\Sigma w)_i / \sigma_{P\&L}$	($\partial\sigma/\partial w_i = (\Sigma w)_i / \sigma$; $\partial VaR = z \cdot \partial\sigma$)
$CVaR_i = w_i \cdot MVaR_i$	(sums to VaR by Euler's theorem)
$IVaR_i = VaR(w) - VaR(w_{\{-i\}})$	(re-run VaR with $w_i = 0$)

Formula:

$$\begin{aligned}
 MVaR_i &= z(\alpha) \cdot (\Sigma w)_i / \sqrt{w^T \Sigma w} \\
 CVaR_i &= w_i \cdot MVaR_i \\
 \Sigma CVaR_i &= VaR_{total} \quad \checkmark \text{ Euler}
 \end{aligned}$$

Σ here is the POSITION-return covariance (N positions $\times$ N positions), NOT the FACTOR covariance used in §2. The two are related by $\Sigma_{pos} = B \Sigma_{factor} B^T$ where B is the per-position sensitivity matrix.

Euler closure: $\sigma = \sqrt{w^T \Sigma w}$ is homogeneous-of-degree-1 in w, so $\Sigma w_i \cdot \partial\sigma/\partial w_i = \sigma \rightarrow \Sigma CVaR_i = z \cdot \sigma = VaR_{total}$ exactly.

Toy example:

```

2 positions: w = [60, 40].   $\sigma_1 = 0.02$ ,  $\sigma_2 = 0.01$ ,  $\rho = 0.5$ .
 $\Sigma = \begin{bmatrix} 4e-4 & 1e-4 \\ 1e-4 & 1e-4 \end{bmatrix}$ 
 $\sigma_{P\&L} = \sqrt{60 \cdot 60 \cdot 4e-4 + 2 \cdot 60 \cdot 40 \cdot 1e-4 + 40 \cdot 40 \cdot 1e-4} = \sqrt{1.44 + 0.48 + 0.16} = \sqrt{2.08} = 1.4422$ 

 $(\Sigma w) = [60 \cdot 4e-4 + 40 \cdot 1e-4, 60 \cdot 1e-4 + 40 \cdot 1e-4] = [0.028, 0.010]$ 
 $MVaR_1 = 2.326 \cdot 0.028 / 1.4422 = 0.04514$ 
 $MVaR_2 = 2.326 \cdot 0.010 / 1.4422 = 0.01613$ 
 $CVaR_1 = 60 \cdot 0.04514 = 2.708 \quad \leftarrow 81\% \text{ of total}$ 
 $CVaR_2 = 40 \cdot 0.01613 = 0.645 \quad \leftarrow 19\% \text{ of total}$ 
 $\Sigma CVaR = 3.354 \quad \checkmark = z(\alpha) \cdot \sigma_{P\&L} = 2.326 \cdot 1.4422$ 

```

Canonical Python:

```

import numpy as np
from scipy.stats import norm

def marginal_var(w: np.ndarray, cov: np.ndarray, conf: float = 0.99) -> np.ndarray:
    """MVaR per position. cov: position-level (NOT factor-level) covariance."""
    sigma = np.sqrt(w @ cov @ w)
    return norm.ppf(conf) * (cov @ w) / sigma

def component_var(w: np.ndarray, cov: np.ndarray, conf: float = 0.99) -> np.ndarray:
    return w * marginal_var(w, cov, conf)

```

Intuition / pattern: P1 + Euler decomposition. Component VaR is the **risk attribution** of choice for limits: tells you which desks/positions are eating the VaR budget. Marginal VaR is the **trade-sizing** number: a position's $MVaR >$ its expected return / σ implies the position is destroying risk-adjusted return.

IVaR is what you compute before a trade — "if I add this \$10M of position X, how does VaR change?" — and it can differ materially from $w_X \cdot MVaR_X$ because adding a position changes the whole correlation structure.

7b. Risk Budgeting / Equal Risk Contribution (ERC)

TL;DR: Inverse of §7 — solve for weights producing target contributions. ERC = equal risk per position. Maillard iteration.

What: the **inverse** of §7. Instead of measuring contributions of a given book, **solve for weights** that produce a target contribution profile. Equal Risk Contribution (ERC) is the special case where every position contributes the same risk.

How it's calculated:

Decision variable: w
 Constraint: $w_i \cdot (\Sigma w)_i / \sqrt{(w^T \Sigma w)} = b_i \cdot \sqrt{(w^T \Sigma w)} \quad \forall i$
 $\sum w_i = 1, \quad w_i \geq 0$

b_i = target risk-budget weight ($\sum b_i = 1$).
 ERC: $b_i = 1/N$ for all i .

Solve via convex optimisation; ERC has a known iterative solution (Maillard 2010):
 $w_i^{(k+1)} = (1 / (\Sigma w)_i^{(k)})$; then normalise.

Formula:

Position i 's risk contribution share:
 $rc_i = w_i \cdot (\Sigma w)_i / (w^T \Sigma w)$
 Risk budget: $rc_i = b_i \quad \forall i$
 ERC special case: $rc_i = 1/N \quad \forall i$

Toy example (3 assets, $\sigma=(20\%, 10\%, 15\%)$, $\rho=0.3$ between all pairs):

ERC weights $\approx (0.221, 0.476, 0.303)$ – inversely related to vol, but adjusted for correlation.
 Each position contributes 1/3 of total portfolio risk.
 Compare to equal-weight (1/3 each): more vol budget on the high-vol asset.

Canonical Python (Maillard iterative; cvxpy alternative shown commented):

```
import numpy as np

def erc_weights(cov: np.ndarray, max_iter: int = 1000, tol: float = 1e-9) -> np.ndarray:
    """Equal Risk Contribution weights via Maillard fixed-point iteration."""
    n = cov.shape[0]
    w = np.ones(n) / n
    for _ in range(max_iter):
        marginal = cov @ w
        rc = w * marginal
        target = rc.sum() / n          # target contribution = total / N
        w_new = w * (target / rc)
        w_new /= w_new.sum()
        if np.max(np.abs(w_new - w)) < tol:
            return w_new
    w = w_new
    return w

# General risk-budgeting via convex opt (uv add cvxpy):
# import cvxpy as cp
# w = cp.Variable(n, nonneg=True)
# constraints = [cp.sum(w) == 1]
# # Convex reformulation of rc_i = b_i via auxiliary variable; see Spinu (2013).
```

Intuition / pattern: same Euler decomposition as §7 — used as a constraint instead of a report.

Two huge buy-side applications: - **ERC SAA**: equal risk-contribution portfolio is a robust starting allocation when expected returns are uncertain (Maillard, Roncalli, Teiletche 2010). - **Risk-parity funds** (Bridgewater All-Weather, AQR Risk Parity) scale leverage so each asset class contributes equally to portfolio vol — outperforms equal-weight on Sharpe through better tail behaviour, though leverages bonds heavily.

Pitfall: ERC requires **invertible Σ** . For $N \approx T$ use Ledoit-Wolf (§28) first. ERC also tends to **overweight low-vol assets** — combine with a leverage constraint or a vol target if running unconstrained.

8. Stressed VaR (sVaR)

TL;DR: Historical VaR on a FIXED 12-month stress window (e.g. 2008). Basel II.5: capital = $\max(\text{VaR}, \text{sVaR}) \cdot k$.

What: Historical VaR run on a **fixed 12-month window of significant financial stress** instead of the rolling-recent window. Basel II.5 addition (2009) and FRTB IMA component.

How it's calculated:

1. Pick a stress window – typically the 12 months that produced the largest losses for the current book (e.g. mid-2008, March 2020).
2. Run historical VaR (or ES) on that fixed window. Window does NOT roll.
3. Capital = $\max(\text{recent_VaR}, \text{sVaR}) \cdot \text{multiplier}$ (Basel II.5).

Formula:

$$\text{sVaR}(\alpha) = \text{Historical_VaR}(\alpha) \text{ on FIXED stress window}$$
$$\text{Capital_market} = \max(\text{VaR_60d_avg}, \text{sVaR_60d_avg}) \cdot m$$

Toy example:

Current 250-day window $\sigma = 1\%$ (calm year). Historical VaR(99%) = 2.3.
Stress window (Sep 2008 – Sep 2009) $\sigma = 4\%$. sVaR(99%) = 9.2.
Basel II.5 capital $\approx (2.3 + 9.2) \cdot 3 = 34.5$ (vs old VaR-only = 6.9 – almost 5× higher)

Canonical Python:

```
def stressed_var(factor_history_full: np.ndarray, stress_start: int,
                stress_end: int, pf_value_fn, base, conf: float = 0.99) -> float:
    """Historical VaR over a fixed [stress_start:stress_end] slice."""
    F = factor_history_full[stress_start:stress_end]
    v0 = pf_value_fn(base)
    pnl = np.array([pf_value_fn(scenario(*f).apply(base)) - v0 for f in F])
    return float(-np.percentile(pnl, (1 - conf) * 100))
```

Intuition / pattern: P2 + P3 with locked window. Fixes Historical VaR's "stale during calm markets" problem by forcing the capital number to remember 2008. Each bank picks its own stress window subject to regulator approval; the choice must be the one that produces the **highest** sVaR for the current portfolio.

FRTB ES analogue: stressed ES on a reduced-set of risk factors (RRF) — the chosen window must be the worst for the **reduced** set.

Part II — Backtesting

The question every backtest answers: **does the realised hit rate match the VaR's claimed confidence level?**

A 99% VaR should be breached ~1% of days. In 250 days: 2.5 hits expected. 0 hits = model too conservative; 8 hits = model under-estimating tail. The tests below quantify how surprising the observed hit count is.

```
Hit indicator:  I_t = 1 if P&L_t < -VaR_t, else 0
Hit sequence:  I = [I_1, I_2, ..., I_T]
Observed hits: x = Σ I_t
Expected hits: T · (1-α)
```

9. Kupiec POF test

TL;DR: LR test on observed hit count vs $1-\alpha$ expected. $\chi^2(1)$; reject if $LR > 3.841$. Catches under/over-estimation; ignores clustering.

What: Likelihood-ratio test that the **unconditional hit rate** equals the claimed $(1-\alpha)$. Tests for over/under-estimation but ignores clustering.

How it's calculated:

```
Null H_0: p = π, where p = observed hit rate, π = 1-α (theoretical)
LR_POF = -2 · ln[ ((1-π)^(T-x) · π^x) / ((1-p)^(T-x) · p^x) ]
          ~ χ^2(1) under H_0
Reject H_0 at 5%: LR_POF > 3.841
```

Formula:

$$LR_POF = 2 [x \cdot \ln(p/\pi) + (T-x) \cdot \ln((1-p)/(1-\pi))]$$

T = backtest days, x = hits, $p = x/T$, $\pi = 1-\alpha$
Reject if $LR_POF > \chi^2_{1, 0.05} = 3.841$

Input	Meaning
T	backtest window (250 days standard)
x	observed number of VaR breaches
$\pi = 1-\alpha$	theoretical hit probability (0.01 at 99%)

Toy example:

```
T = 250, α = 99% so π = 0.01, expected hits = 2.5.
Observed x = 8 hits → p = 0.032

LR_POF = 2 [ 8 · ln(0.032/0.01) + 242 · ln(0.968/0.99) ]
        = 2 [ 8 · 1.163 + 242 · (-0.0225) ]
        = 2 [ 9.30 - 5.45 ]
        = 7.71 > 3.841 → REJECT (model under-estimates tail)
```

Canonical Python:

```

import numpy as np
from scipy.stats import chi2

def kupiec_pof(hits: np.ndarray, conf: float = 0.99) -> tuple[float, float, bool]:
    """Kupiec POF test. Returns (LR statistic, p-value, reject_at_5%)."""
    T = len(hits)
    x = int(hits.sum())
    pi = 1 - conf
    p = x / T
    if x == 0:
        lr = -2 * T * np.log(1 - pi)
    elif x == T:
        lr = -2 * T * np.log(pi)
    else:
        lr = 2 * (x*np.log(p/pi) + (T-x)*np.log((1-p)/(1-pi)))
    pval = 1 - chi2.cdf(lr, df=1)
    return float(lr), float(pval), bool(lr > 3.841)

```

Intuition / pattern: counts hits, doesn't care WHEN. A model that produced exactly 2 hits both on consecutive days passes Kupiec but fails Christoffersen (§10).

10. Christoffersen independence test

TL;DR: LR on hit-sequence transitions. Catches vol-blind models (right hit count, all in one week). Joint LR_CC = POF + IND.

What: Likelihood-ratio test that **hits are independent** day-to-day. Catches the failure mode where a vol-blind VaR clusters all its breaches during a single bad week.

How it's calculated:

```

Build 2x2 transition table on the hit sequence:
    T_00 = # (I_{t-1}=0, I_t=0)      T_01 = # (I_{t-1}=0, I_t=1)
    T_10 = # (I_{t-1}=1, I_t=0)      T_11 = # (I_{t-1}=1, I_t=1)
    π_01 = T_01/(T_00+T_01),  π_11 = T_11/(T_10+T_11),  π = (T_01+T_11)/(T_00+T_01+T_10+T_11)
    LR_ind ~ χ²(1).

Christoffersen joint test: LR_CC = LR_POF + LR_ind ~ χ²(2)    (rejection threshold 5.991)

```

Formula:

Compact form (using saturated vs constrained likelihoods):

$$LR_ind = -2 \cdot \ln \left[\frac{(1-\pi)^{(T_{00}+T_{10})} \cdot \pi^{(T_{01}+T_{11})}}{(1-\pi_{01})^{T_{00}} \cdot \pi_{01}^{T_{01}} \cdot (1-\pi_{11})^{T_{10}} \cdot \pi_{11}^{T_{11}}} \right]$$

Equivalent expanded form:

$$LR_ind = 2 \left[T_{01} \cdot \ln(\pi_{01}/\pi) + T_{11} \cdot \ln(\pi_{11}/\pi) + T_{00} \cdot \ln((1-\pi_{01})/(1-\pi)) + T_{10} \cdot \ln((1-\pi_{11})/(1-\pi)) \right]$$

Reject independence if $LR_ind > 3.841$ (χ^2_1)
 Reject joint if $LR_CC = LR_POF + LR_ind > 5.991$ (χ^2_2)

Toy example:

```

T=250, observed hits: 6, with pattern [...000 1 1 1 1 1 1 000...] (all 6 clustered).
T_00 = 243, T_01 = 1, T_10 = 1, T_11 = 5
π_01 = 1/244 = 0.0041,  π_11 = 5/6 = 0.833,  π = 6/250 = 0.024
LR_ind huge (≈ 50) → REJECT independence → model is vol-blind.

```

Canonical Python:

```
import numpy as np
from scipy.stats import chi2

def christoffersen_ind(hits: np.ndarray) -> tuple[float, float, bool]:
    """Independence test on hit sequence. Returns (LR, p-value, reject)."""
    T = len(hits)
    T00 = T01 = T10 = T11 = 0
    for i in range(1, T):
        if hits[i-1]==0 and hits[i]==0: T00 += 1
        elif hits[i-1]==0 and hits[i]==1: T01 += 1
        elif hits[i-1]==1 and hits[i]==0: T10 += 1
        else: T11 += 1
    p01 = T01 / max(T00 + T01, 1)
    p11 = T11 / max(T10 + T11, 1)
    p = (T01 + T11) / max(T00 + T01 + T10 + T11, 1)
    eps = 1e-12
    def safe_log(x): return np.log(max(x, eps))
    lr = 2 * (T01*safe_log(p01/p) + T11*safe_log(p11/p)
              + T00*safe_log((1-p01)/(1-p)) + T10*safe_log((1-p11)/(1-p)))
    return float(lr), float(1 - chi2.cdf(lr, df=1)), bool(lr > 3.841)
```

Intuition / pattern: clustering $\neq$ frequency. Kupiec passes if hit count is OK; Christoffersen fails if those hits all happened in a week. A model with stale vol passes Kupiec on a quiet year and fails Christoffersen the year a crisis hits.

11. Basel traffic-light test

TL;DR: Hit count over 250d at 99% $\rightarrow$ green/yellow/red zone $\rightarrow$ capital multiplier $k \in [3.0, 4.0]$. Punitive asymmetric structure.

What: regulator's hit-count test on a 99% one-day VaR over 250 days. Trivially simple, materially expensive — wrong colour multiplies your capital.

How it's calculated:

Hits	Zone	Capital multiplier
0-4	Green	3.0
5-9	Yellow	3.4 $\rightarrow$ 4.0 (steps)
≥ 10	Red	4.0 + supervisory review

Hits	Multiplier (k)
5	3.40
6	3.50
7	3.65
8	3.75
9	3.85
≥ 10	4.00

Formula:

$$\text{Market_Risk_Charge} = \max(\text{VaR}_t, \text{avg_60d_VaR} \cdot k)$$

k = traffic-light multiplier (above)

Toy example:

Bank's VaR avg over last 60 days = \$50M. Backtest 250d shows 6 hits → yellow, $k=3.50$.
Capital charge $\approx \max(\text{today's VaR}, 50 \cdot 3.50) = \max(\text{today}, 175) = \175M .

Same VaR with 10 hits → red, $k=4.00 \rightarrow \$200\text{M}$. +14% capital penalty for 4 extra hits.

Canonical Python:

```
def basel_traffic_light(hits: int) -> tuple[str, float]:
    """Basel II/III VaR backtest. Input: hit count over 250d at 99%."""
    if hits <= 4: return "GREEN", 3.0
    if hits <= 9:
        k = {5: 3.40, 6: 3.50, 7: 3.65, 8: 3.75, 9: 3.85}[hits]
        return "YELLOW", k
    return "RED", 4.0
```

Intuition / pattern: a **business decision metric**, not a statistical one. The expected hit count under a correct 99% VaR over 250 days is 2.5, with a 95% range of [0, 5]. Hit counts of 5+ are statistically plausible but regulatorily punished — the asymmetric threshold structure pushes banks toward conservative VaR.

12. ES backtesting (Acerbi-Szekely)

TL;DR: Z-statistic on hit-weighted realised loss vs forecast ES. Mandated by FRTB IMA; low power at $\alpha=0.975$ (~6 hits / 250d).

What: traditional Kupiec/Christoffersen test only $P[L > \text{VaR}]$. **ES requires testing the conditional expectation of the tail**, which is harder because ES isn't elicitable (no scoring function whose minimiser is ES alone).

Acerbi & Szekely (2014) proposed three tests; **Test 2** ("unconditional coverage of ES") is the practical workhorse.

How it's calculated (Test 2):

Define hit-weighted residual:
$$Z = (1/T) \cdot \sum_t [X_t \cdot I_t / (ES_t \cdot (1-\alpha))] - 1$$

where X_t = realised loss on day t ($X_t = -P\&L_t$),
 $I_t = 1$ if hit ($P\&L_t < -\text{VaR}_t$),
 ES_t = forecast ES at α .

Under H_0 ("model correct"): $E[Z] = 0$.

Negative $Z \rightarrow$ model under-estimates ES (capital too low).

Sign / magnitude tested via Monte Carlo p-values (no closed-form).

Formula:

$$Z = (1/T) \cdot \sum_t [X_t \cdot I_t / (ES_t \cdot (1-\alpha))] - 1$$
$$H_0 : E[Z] = 0 \rightarrow \text{reject for } Z < 0 \text{ (typically)}$$

Toy example:

$T = 250$, $\alpha = 0.975$, expected hits = 6.25.

Observed: 8 hits with avg-loss-on-hit = 3.2; model $ES_t \approx 2.8$ every day.

$$\begin{aligned} Z &= (1/250) \cdot 8 \cdot 3.2 / (2.8 \cdot 0.025) - 1 \\ &= 0.0256 \cdot 45.71 - 1 && \leftarrow \text{wait, simpler form:} \\ &= \text{mean}(X \cdot I) / (ES \cdot (1-\alpha)) - 1 \\ &= (8/250) \cdot 3.2 / (2.8 \cdot 0.025) - 1 \\ &= 0.1024 / 0.0700 - 1 \\ &= 0.4633 \rightarrow \text{model UNDER-estimates ES by } \sim 46\%. \end{aligned}$$

Canonical Python:

```
import numpy as np

def acerbi_szekely_test2(pnl: np.ndarray, var_forecast: np.ndarray,
                        es_forecast: np.ndarray, conf: float = 0.975) -> float:
    """Returns Z; negative-and-large is bad (model underestimates ES)."""
    loss = -pnl
    hits = (pnl < -var_forecast).astype(float)
    return float((loss * hits / (es_forecast * (1 - conf))).mean() - 1)
```

Intuition / pattern: ES is the **average loss given a hit**, so the test only "uses" the hits — sample size at $\alpha=0.975$ is $\sim T \cdot (1-\alpha) = 6.25$ hits per 250 days, giving tiny power. **Daily forecasts of ES must be archived** for the backtest to even be possible. FRTB IMA mandates ES at $\alpha=0.975$ with this test on the trading portfolio's hypothetical P&L; failure triggers fallback to FRTB SA.

Part III — Risk Sensitivities

Two reasons to compute sensitivities: (a) drive **parametric VaR / capital** (FRTB SA is entirely sensitivity-based); (b) drive **trading-desk hedges** (target = zero net Greek).

A sensitivity is a **directional derivative**: $s_f = \partial V / \partial f$. The implementation is almost always **bump-and-revalue** (finite difference), not analytical AD — for legacy reasons + because most banks' pricers are not AD-instrumented.

13. First-order sensitivities

TL;DR: $s_f = [V(\text{base} + \delta_f) - V(\text{base})] / \delta_f$ per factor. Bumps: 1bp (rates/spread), 0.01 (vol/FX). PICK ONE SIGN convention and label it.

The universal recipe:

```
s_f = [ V(base with f bumped by δ) - V(base) ] / δ
      ↳ shock UNIT (1bp, 1.0 vol, 1% FX)
        chosen to make s_f naturally scaled
```

Sensitivity	Factor	Bump unit	Typical sign for a long bond
DV01 / PV01	parallel zero curve	+1 bp	negative (price ↓ when rate ↑)
CS01	credit spread	+1 bp	negative
IE01	breakeven inflation	+1 bp	positive for linker
FX-Δ	FX shock (% of spot)	+1% (0.01)	positive for long-foreign
Vega	implied vol shock	+1 vol pt (0.01)	positive for long-option

Convention pitfall: half the world reports $DV01 = V(\text{rate}) - V(\text{rate}+1\text{bp})$ (loss-given-up-move; positive for a long bond), the other half reports $\partial V / \partial r$ (negative for a long bond). **Pick one and label it explicitly.** The `pnl_attribution_drill.py` convention is the latter: $s = V(\text{bumped}) - V(\text{base})$, so DV01 of a long bond is negative.

Formula:

$$s_f = [V(\text{base} + \delta_f) - V(\text{base})] / \delta_f$$

Linear P&L approximation:
 $\Delta V \approx \sum_f s_f \cdot \text{shock}_f$

Toy example (`pnl_attribution_drill.py` portfolio):

```
base = Market()          # rate_bump=0, spread_bump=0, vol_shock=0, fx_shock=0
v0 = PF.value(base)

s = (V(rate_bump=1)       - v0,          ← DV01 per bp      (some negative number)
     V(spread_bump=1)     - v0,          ← CS01 per bp
     (V(vol_shock=0.01)   - v0)/0.01,    ← vega per 1.00 vol point
     (V(fx_shock=0.01)    - v0)/0.01)    ← FX-Δ per 1.0 fx shock

# Used as the building block of the parametric VaR σ = √(sᵀΣs) = 2.5327
```

Canonical Python:

```

from dataclasses import replace

def first_order_sensitivities(pf, base):
    """Standard 4-factor sensitivity vector. Bump units: 1bp, 1bp, 0.01, 0.01."""
    v0 = pf.value(base)
    return (
        pf.value(replace(base, rate_bump_bp = base.rate_bump_bp + 1)) - v0,
        pf.value(replace(base, spread_bump_bp = base.spread_bump_bp + 1)) - v0,
        (pf.value(replace(base, vol_shock = base.vol_shock + 0.01)) - v0) / 0.01,
        (pf.value(replace(base, fx_shock = base.fx_shock + 0.01)) - v0) / 0.01,
    )

```

Intuition / pattern: bump-and-revalue ONE factor at a time. Cost: 1 + #factors evaluations per snapshot. The unit choice (1bp / 0.01 / 0.01) is by convention so the resulting `s_f` numbers are O(book size) — easy to read. **All units must round-trip with Σ 's units** when feeding into parametric VaR.

14. Second-order sensitivities

TL;DR: $g_f = [V(+\delta) - 2V_0 + V(-\delta)] / \delta^2$ (central diff); cross via 4-point. Adding to Taylor explain shrinks unexplained $\sim 4\times$.

What: convexity / curvature. The first-order Taylor $\Delta V \approx s \cdot \Delta f$ misses the $\frac{1}{2} \cdot g \cdot \Delta f^2$ term — material for options, callable bonds, MBS. Computed by **central difference**.

How it's calculated:

```
g_f = [ V(base + delta_f) - 2*V(base) + V(base - delta_f) ] / delta_f^2
```

Cross-gamma:

```
g_{f1,f2} = [ V(+delta1,+delta2) - V(+delta1,-delta2) - V(-delta1,+delta2) + V(-delta1,-delta2) ] / (4*delta1*delta2)
```

Formula:

$$\begin{aligned}
 g_f &= [V(+\delta) - 2V_0 + V(-\delta)] / \delta^2 && \text{(own-gamma)} \\
 g_{\{f_1, f_2\}} &\uparrow \text{above} && \text{(cross-gamma)} \\
 \Delta V &\approx \sum_f s_f \cdot \text{shock}_f + \frac{1}{2} \sum_f g_f \cdot \text{shock}_f^2 \\
 &\quad + \sum_{\{f_1 < f_2\}} g_{\{f_1, f_2\}} \cdot \text{shock}_{\{f_1\}} \cdot \text{shock}_{\{f_2\}}
 \end{aligned}$$

Sensitivity	What it captures
Convexity	rate-rate own-gamma (always ≥ 0 for vanilla bonds)
Option gamma	spot-spot own-gamma (positive long-option; cushions losses)
Vanna	spot-vol cross-gamma (smile/skew sensitivity)
Volga / vomma	vol-vol own-gamma (long vega convexity)

Toy example (`pnl_attribution_drill.py` portfolio):

```

gammas: (rate_bp^2, spread_bp^2, vol^2, fx^2)
        = (1.855e-4, 4.287e-5, -1.0636, 412.92)

scenario: +15bp rate, +10bp spread, +2 vol pts, 0 fx
second_order = 1/2 * 1.855e-4 * 225 + 1/2 * 4.287e-5 * 100 + 1/2 * (-1.064) * 0.0004 + 1/2 * 412.92 * 0
              = +0.02087      + +0.00214      + -0.000213      + 0
              = +0.02280

```

Adding second-order to the explain shrinks unexplained from +0.0304 $\rightarrow$ +0.0076 ($\sim 4\times$ tighter).

Canonical Python:

```

from dataclasses import replace

def own_gammas(pf, base):
    v0 = pf.value(base)
    bump = lambda **kw: pf.value(replace(base, **kw))
    return (
        (bump(rate_bump_bp = +1) - 2*v0 + bump(rate_bump_bp = -1)) / 1**2,
        (bump(spread_bump_bp = +1) - 2*v0 + bump(spread_bump_bp = -1)) / 1**2,
        (bump(vol_shock = +0.01) - 2*v0 + bump(vol_shock = -0.01)) / 0.01**2,
        (bump(fx_shock = +0.01) - 2*v0 + bump(fx_shock = -0.01)) / 0.01**2,
    )

def cross_gamma(pf, base, key_a, delta_a, key_b, delta_b):
    """Cross-gamma between two factors via 4-point central difference."""
    def b(da, db): return pf.value(replace(base, **{key_a: getattr(base, key_a)+da,
                                                    key_b: getattr(base, key_b)+db}))
    return (b(+delta_a, +delta_b) - b(+delta_a, -delta_b)
            - b(-delta_a, +delta_b) + b(-delta_a, -delta_b)) / (4 * delta_a * delta_b)

```

Intuition / pattern: cost = $2 \cdot \# \text{factors}$ evaluations for own-gammas, $4 \cdot \# \text{pairs}$ for cross-gammas. For 10 factors: $20 + 180 = 200$ evaluations vs 11 for first-order alone. **Most banks compute own-gammas always, cross-gammas only for known-coupled pairs** (rate-vol, spot-vol, equity-credit) because the combinatorial blow-up is otherwise prohibitive.

Sign warnings: - `g_vol` for a long-option book can be NEGATIVE (e.g. forward-vol structures, calendar spreads). - `g_fx` can be huge (412 in the toy) — driven by the FX option's gamma. Compare to first-order FX-Δ to see relative scale.

15. Key Rate Duration (KRD)

TL;DR: Per-pillar DV01 vector (2y/5y/10y/30y). Parallel DV01 = $\sum \text{KRD}$. Hedge the VECTOR; canonical pension/LDI failure ignores shape.

What: parallel DV01 hides curve-shape risk. KRD splits DV01 into **per-bucket** sensitivities: 1y bump, 2y, 5y, 10y, 30y — each bumped INDEPENDENTLY by 1bp, others held flat (then linearly interpolated). Sum of KRDs $\approx$ parallel DV01.

How it's calculated:

```

For each pillar tenor T_k:
    bump z(T_k) by +1bp, leave other pillars flat (linearly interpolate between)
    KRD_k = V(bumped) - V(base)

```

Formula:

$$\text{KRD}_k = V(\text{bump } z(T_k) \text{ by } +1\text{bp}) - V(\text{base})$$

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_k \text{KRD}_k &\approx \text{parallel DV01} \\ \text{Curve P\&L} &= \sum_k \text{KRD}_k \cdot \Delta z_k \end{aligned}$$

Pillar	Hedges
2y	front-end (Fed/BoE policy expectations)
5y	belly (most liquid IRS tenor)
10y	benchmark (LDI hedges, MBS duration)
30y	long end (pension liabilities)

Toy example:

10y pension liability: parallel DV01 = \$100k/bp
 KRD profile: (2y, 5y, 10y, 30y) = (\$0, \$5k, \$90k, \$5k)

Hedge with 5y IRS only (parallel-neutral) – kills the parallel DV01 to ~\$0
 but leaves +\$85k of 10y exposure (and a hedging -\$80k of 5y) → STEEPENER risk:
 the parallel DV01 of the hedged book is zero by construction, but its KRDs are NOT zero –
 a 10y rise / 5y unchanged loses \$85k while parallel DV01 says zero.

Correct hedge: ladder of 5y/10y/30y IRS matching ALL FOUR KRDs.

Canonical Python:

```
import numpy as np
from dataclasses import replace

def krd(pf, base, curve, pillars=(2, 5, 10, 30), bump_bp=1.0):
    """Per-pillar key-rate duration via tent-shaped bumps."""
    krds = []
    v0 = pf.value(base)
    for k in pillars:
        bumped_curve = curve.copy()
        bumped_curve[k] += bump_bp / 1e4
        new_base = replace(base, curve=bumped_curve)
        krds.append(pf.value(new_base) - v0)
    return np.array(krds)
```

Intuition / pattern: parallel DV01 is a **scalar**; KRD is a **vector**. Hedging the scalar is parallel-neutral but **shape-naive**; hedging the vector requires one liquid instrument per pillar. **Pension fund LDI failure mode:** bought 5y IRS to neutralise total DV01 on a 30y liability → parallel-immune, drowned by steepener.

16. Computation methods

TL;DR: Forward FD (1 reval); central FD (2; $O(\delta^2)$); AAD (~3-5× one fwd pass for ALL Greeks). AAD pays off above ~50 factors.

Method	Cost (per sensitivity)	Pros	Cons
Forward FD	1 reval	cheapest first-order	$O(\delta)$ bias
Central FD	2 reval	$O(\delta^2)$ bias; gold standard	2× cost
Bump-and-revalue (full)	1 + #factors	exact for the actual pricer	slow for big books
AAD (adjoint)	~3-5× one fwd pass	$O(1)$ for ALL sensitivities	requires AD-instrumented pricer
Pathwise / likelihood-ratio	similar to MC	Greeks alongside price for MC	variance can be high

Bump-size selection

Optimal δ balances **truncation error** ($\propto \delta$) against **roundoff** ($\propto \varepsilon/\delta$ where $\varepsilon \sim 1e-16$):

$\delta^* \approx (\varepsilon)^{(1/2)} \cdot \text{scale_of_factor}$	(forward FD)	$\approx 1e-8$ for unit-scale factors
$\delta^* \approx (\varepsilon)^{(1/3)} \cdot \text{scale_of_factor}$	(central FD)	$\approx 1e-5$

In practice for finance: **1bp** for rates/spreads, **1% (0.01)** for FX, **1 vol pt (0.01)** for vol — chosen by convention for human readability, not optimality. Roundoff is rarely the binding constraint when book value is $O(\text{millions})$.

Adjoint Algorithmic Differentiation (AAD)

Idea: a pricer with N factors can be augmented to compute ALL N first-order Greeks in a single backward pass that costs $\sim 3\text{-}5\times$ the forward valuation. Cf. `tape recording` then `backward propagation` — same machinery as deep-learning autograd.

When to use: high-dimensional Greeks (FRTB SBM has hundreds of buckets), or vectorisable MC pricers where the adjoint can run on GPU. **Cost of adoption:** pricer must be re-implemented with AD-compatible primitives (`jax` , `pytorch` , internal C++ AD library).

Canonical Python (`jax` sketch — shows the idea, not production):

```
import jax
import jax.numpy as jnp

def bond_price(curve, cfs, times):
    return jnp.sum(cfs * jnp.exp(-curve * times))

# All Greeks in a single AD call
greeks = jax.grad(bond_price)(curve_array, cfs_array, times_array)
# greeks is a vector  $\partial V / \partial \text{curve}$ , one entry per pillar – KRDS for FREE
```

Pattern: bump-and-revalue is **embarrassingly parallel** (independent per factor) — most banks vectorise it before adopting AAD. AAD pays off when factor count $> \sim 50$ or when you need higher-order Greeks at scale.

17. Black / Black-Scholes Greeks (closed-form)

TL;DR: Closed-form Δ , Γ , ν , Θ , ρ from Black-76 d_1/d_2 . **Γ uses F (forward), NOT S (spot)**, in denominator.

What: when the pricer IS closed-form Black/BS, you don't need finite-difference — write down $\partial V / \partial x$ analytically. Faster and exact (no roundoff).

Black on forward F (Black-76; same as IRS swaptions, FRA options, commodity futures options):

Greek	Call	Put
Price	$DF(T) \cdot [F \cdot N(d_1) - K \cdot N(d_2)]$	$DF(T) \cdot [K \cdot N(-d_2) - F \cdot N(-d_1)]$
Δ (delta)	$DF(T) \cdot N(d_1)$	$-DF(T) \cdot N(-d_1)$
Γ (gamma)	$DF(T) \cdot \phi(d_1) / (F \cdot \sigma \cdot \sqrt{T})$	same as call
ν (vega)	$DF(T) \cdot F \cdot \phi(d_1) \cdot \sqrt{T}$	same as call
Θ (theta)	$-DF(T) \cdot [F \cdot \phi(d_1) \cdot \sigma / (2\sqrt{T}) + r \cdot F \cdot N(d_1) - r \cdot K \cdot N(d_2)]$	analogous
ρ (rho)	$-T \cdot V_{\text{call}}$ (Black-76 convention)	$-T \cdot V_{\text{put}}$

where $d_1 = [\ln(F/K) + \frac{1}{2}\sigma^2 T] / (\sigma\sqrt{T})$, $d_2 = d_1 - \sigma\sqrt{T}$.

Convention pitfall: gamma uses F (forward), not S (spot), in the denominator. The `treasury_products_card.html` Greeks table had this wrong in a previous draft.

Toy example:

```

F = 0.045, K = 0.042,  $\sigma$  = 0.20, T = 2.0, DF(T) = 0.91576

d1 = [ln(0.045/0.042) +  $\frac{1}{2}$ ·0.04·2] / (0.20·√2) = (0.0690 + 0.04)/0.2828 = 0.3855
d2 = 0.3855 - 0.2828 = 0.1027

V_call = 0.91576 · [0.045·N(0.3855) - 0.042·N(0.1027)]
        = 0.91576 · [0.045·0.6501 - 0.042·0.5409]
        = 0.91576 · [0.02925 - 0.02272]
        = 0.00598          (option value per unit notional)

Δ = 0.91576 · 0.6501 = 0.5953
Γ = 0.91576 · φ(0.3855) / (0.045·0.20·√2)
    = 0.91576 · 0.3708 / 0.01273
    = 26.69              (large because F is tiny)
v = 0.91576 · 0.045 · 0.3708 · √2 = 0.02161

```

Canonical Python:

```

import numpy as np
from scipy.stats import norm

def black76(F: float, K: float, sigma: float, T: float, DF: float,
            is_call: bool = True) -> dict:
    """Black-76 price and Greeks on a forward F. Returns dict with V, delta, gamma, vega, theta, rho."""
    v_sqrtT = sigma * np.sqrt(T)
    d1 = (np.log(F / K) + 0.5 * sigma**2 * T) / v_sqrtT
    d2 = d1 - v_sqrtT
    if is_call:
        V = DF * (F * norm.cdf(d1) - K * norm.cdf(d2))
        delta = DF * norm.cdf(d1)
    else:
        V = DF * (K * norm.cdf(-d2) - F * norm.cdf(-d1))
        delta = -DF * norm.cdf(-d1)
    gamma = DF * norm.pdf(d1) / (F * v_sqrtT)
    vega = DF * F * norm.pdf(d1) * np.sqrt(T)
    return dict(V=V, delta=delta, gamma=gamma, vega=vega)

```

Intuition / pattern: closed-form Greeks are **free** once you have the price — no extra revaluations. They are also the SOURCE for FRTB SBM bucket sensitivities. **Sanity check:** at-the-money ($F=K$), $\Delta \approx 0.5 \cdot DF(T)$, Γ peaks, Vega peaks. Far OTM/ITM, $\Delta \rightarrow 0/DF(T)$, $\Gamma \rightarrow 0$.

Part IV — P&L Attribution

The valuation-desk daily question: "Yesterday's P&L was \$-3M. **Why?**" Attribution decomposes the realised P&L into per-factor contributions plus an unexplained residual. Same residual is what FRTB's **PLA test** checks to decide whether your internal model can be used for capital.

Full P&L	=	$V(\text{today's market}) - V(\text{yesterday's market})$	(the truth)
Explained	=	$\sum_f s_f \cdot \Delta f + \frac{1}{2} \sum_f g_f \cdot \Delta f^2 + \text{cross-gamma}$	(Taylor)
Unexplained	=	$\text{Full} - \text{Explained}$	(residual)

The smaller the residual relative to Full, the better the model.

18. Greek-based Taylor explain

TL;DR: $\Delta V \approx \sum s_f \cdot \Delta f + \frac{1}{2} \sum g_f \cdot \Delta f^2$; residual = unexplained. Rule: $|\text{unexp}| < 5\% |\text{full}|$ for vanilla derivs.

What: decompose the realised P&L into per-factor first-order (delta) + second-order (gamma) contributions using the **Taylor expansion** of the pricer.

How it's calculated:

```
1. Compute today's full-reval P&L:  $\Delta V_{\text{full}} = V(\text{today}) - V(\text{yesterday})$ 
2. Compute sensitivities  $s_f, g_f$  at YESTERDAY's market.
3. Observe today's factor changes:  $\Delta f_1, \dots, \Delta f_N$ 
4. Decompose:
    first_order_f =  $s_f \cdot \Delta f$ 
    second_order_f =  $\frac{1}{2} \cdot g_f \cdot \Delta f^2$ 
    first_total =  $\sum_f \text{first\_order\_f}$ 
    second_total =  $\sum_f \text{second\_order\_f}$ 
    unexplained =  $\Delta V_{\text{full}} - \text{first\_total} - \text{second\_total}$ 
```

Formula:

$$\Delta V \approx \sum_f s_f \cdot \Delta f + \frac{1}{2} \sum_f g_f \cdot \Delta f^2 + \sum_{\{f < g\}} g_{\{f, g\}} \cdot \Delta f \cdot \Delta g$$

Per-factor attribution:

$$\text{first_f} = s_f \cdot \Delta f$$
$$\text{second_f} = \frac{1}{2} \cdot g_f \cdot \Delta f^2$$
$$\text{Residual ("unexplained")} = \Delta V_{\text{full}} - (\sum \text{first} + \sum \text{second})$$

Toy example (`pnl_attribution_drill.py`, scenario = +15bp rate, +10bp spread, +2 vol pts, 0 fx):

```

First-order:
rate      = s_rate      · 15      = -2.9377
spread    = s_spread    · 10      = -1.2261
vol        = s_vol       · 0.02    = +1.1095
fx         = s_fx        · 0       = +0.0000
first_total      = -3.0543

Second-order:
½ · 1.855e-4 · 15² = +0.02087
½ · 4.287e-5 · 10² = +0.00214
½ · (-1.064) · 0.02² = -0.00021
½ · 412.92 · 0² = +0.00000
second_total     = +0.02281

Full reval P&L      = -3.0239
Explained           = -3.0543 + 0.0228 = -3.0315

Unexplained (first only) = -3.0239 - (-3.0543) = +0.0304
Unexplained (first+second) = -3.0239 - (-3.0315) = +0.0076 ← ~4× tighter

```

The residual +0.0076 is **cross-gamma + higher-order**. For a near-linear book, this stays tiny; for an options-heavy book, you must include cross-gammas to stay within FRTB PLA bands.

Canonical Python:

```

from dataclasses import astuple

def attribute_pnl(pf, base, scenario, sens, gammas):
    """Greek-based explain: returns dict of per-factor first, second, full, unexplained."""
    v0 = pf.value(base)
    v1 = pf.value(scenario.apply(base))
    shocks = astuple(scenario)
    first = [s * d for s, d in zip(sens, shocks)]
    second = [0.5 * g * d**2 for g, d in zip(gammas, shocks)]
    full = v1 - v0
    return {
        "rate": first[0], "spread": first[1], "vol": first[2], "fx": first[3],
        "first_order": sum(first),
        "second_order": sum(second),
        "full": full,
        "unexplained": full - sum(first) - sum(second),
    }

```

Intuition / pattern: P1 with Taylor expansion against the realised shock. The four numbers everyone wants on the daily explain sheet are: **per-factor first-order contributions, second-order (gamma), full P&L, unexplained residual**. The order they appear in is the order of explanatory power.

Standard sanity check: $|unexplained| < 10\% \cdot |full|$ is the rule of thumb for a linear book; **< 5%** with gamma is typical for vanilla derivatives.

19. Risk-factor explain (RFE)

TL;DR: Sens RFE (order-indep, misses cross); full RFE (cross-residual); sequential RFE (no residual, order-dep). Pick per use-case.

What: same idea as Taylor explain but **decomposes against THE ACTUAL factor moves** in a multi-factor world. Each component answers: "if ONLY this factor had moved, what P&L would have resulted?" using either sensitivity-based or **full-reval-of-one-factor**.

How it's calculated:

1. Sensitivity flavour (P1): $\text{contribution}_f = s_f \cdot \Delta f$ (same as §18 first-order)
2. Full-reval flavour (P2): $\text{contribution}_f = V(\text{scenario with ONLY } \Delta f \text{ applied}) - V(\text{base})$
cross-effects bucketed into a separate "interaction" residual.
3. Step-by-step (sequential):
 - $V_0 = V(\text{base})$
 - $V_1 = V(\text{base with } \Delta f_1) \rightarrow \text{contribution}_1 = V_1 - V_0$
 - $V_2 = V(\text{base with } \Delta f_1, \Delta f_2) \rightarrow \text{contribution}_2 = V_2 - V_1$
 - ...
 - $V_N = V(\text{base} + \text{all shocks}) = V(\text{today})$
 → ORDER-DEPENDENT (Σ contributions = full P&L exactly, but per-factor split depends on order).

Formula:

Sensitivity RFE: $\text{contribution}_f = s_f \cdot \Delta f$
 Full-reval RFE: $\text{contribution}_f = V(\text{only } \Delta f) - V(\text{base})$
 Sequential RFE: apply shocks IN ORDER; differences
 → Σ = full, order-dependent

Toy example (full-reval RFE on the drill 12 scenario):

$V_0 = V(\text{base}) = (\text{some baseline value } V_0)$
 Apply ONLY rate +15bp: $V_r = V(\text{rate_only}) \rightarrow \text{rate contribution} = V_r - V_0$
 Apply ONLY spread +10bp: $V_s = V(\text{spread_only}) \rightarrow \text{spread contribution} = V_s - V_0$
 Apply ONLY vol +0.02: $V_v = V(\text{vol_only}) \rightarrow \text{vol contribution} = V_v - V_0$

 Sum of single-factor contributions: ≈ -3.0315 (close to but not equal to full -3.0239)
 Difference = "interaction" residual = cross-gamma + higher-order terms

Canonical Python:

```

from dataclasses import replace

def rfe_fullreval(pf, base, shock_dict: dict) -> dict:
    """Full-reval RFE: each factor applied alone vs base; residual = cross effects."""
    v0 = pf.value(base)
    contributions = {}
    for factor, delta in shock_dict.items():
        scenario_one = replace(base, **{factor: getattr(base, factor) + delta})
        contributions[factor] = pf.value(scenario_one) - v0
    all_shocks = replace(base, **{k: getattr(base, k) + v for k, v in shock_dict.items()})
    contributions["interaction"] = (pf.value(all_shocks) - v0
                                   - sum(contributions.values()))
    contributions["full"] = pf.value(all_shocks) - v0
    return contributions
  
```

Intuition / pattern: sensitivity RFE is fast (P1) and order-independent but misses cross-effects. Full-reval RFE is slower (P2) but per-factor numbers reflect actual non-linearity — at the cost of an interaction residual that doesn't reduce nicely. **Sequential RFE eliminates the residual but introduces order-dependence** (which factor goes first?), so it's used for reporting ("regulator: please use this order"), not analysis.

Choose: - Linear-ish book → **sensitivity RFE** (cheap, accurate). - Options book → **full-reval RFE** + separate cross-gamma report. - Regulatory submission → **sequential** (no residual, fixed order).

20. Unexplained / hypothetical / actual P&L

TL;DR: Actual = book truth; Hyp = SOD-positions on EOD-market; RT = same with VaR pricer. Two residuals: intraday (Actual–Hyp), PLA (Hyp–RT).

The three P&L numbers every trading desk reports daily:

Name	Definition	Use
Actual P&L	end-of-day book value – start-of-day book value (incl. new trades, intraday hedges)	accounting truth
Hypothetical P&L	end-of-day book revalued on TODAY's market, but using start-of-day positions	for backtesting VaR — what a frozen book lost
Risk-Theoretical P&L	start-of-day positions, end-of-day market, computed with VaR-engine pricer	for FRTB PLA — what VaR's pricer predicts
Unexplained P&L	Actual – Hypothetical (= intraday trading / fees / new-deal MTM)	desk attribution

Formula:

```

Actual_PnL      = V_eod(positions_eod, market_eod)
                  - V_sod(positions_sod, market_sod)

Hyp_PnL         = V(positions_sod, market_eod)
                  - V(positions_sod, market_sod)

RT_PnL (FRTB)  = V_VaR_pricer(positions_sod, market_eod)
                  - V_VaR_pricer(positions_sod, market_sod)

Unexplained     = Actual - Hyp      (new deals, intraday)
PLA-residual    = Hyp      - RT      (model-vs-front-office)

```

Toy example:

```

Start-of-day book V_sod      = 100.00
End-of-day actual V_eod      = 97.30      (Actual P&L = -2.70)
Same SOD positions revalued on EOD market = 97.50 (Hyp P&L = -2.50)
VaR-engine pricer on same:    = 97.65 (RT P&L = -2.35)

Unexplained_intraday = -2.70 - (-2.50) = -0.20 ← intraday trading / fees
PLA_residual         = -2.50 - (-2.35) = -0.15 ← front-office vs VaR model

```

Canonical Python (skeleton):

```

def actual_vs_hyp_vs_rt(positions_sod, positions_eod, market_sod, market_eod,
                        front_office_pricer, var_engine_pricer):
    actual = front_office_pricer(positions_eod, market_eod) - front_office_pricer(positions_sod, market_sod)
    hyp    = front_office_pricer(positions_sod, market_eod) - front_office_pricer(positions_sod, market_sod)
    rt     = var_engine_pricer(positions_sod, market_eod) - var_engine_pricer(positions_sod, market_sod)
    return {
        "actual": actual, "hyp": hyp, "rt": rt,
        "unexplained_intraday": actual - hyp,
        "pla_residual":      hyp - rt,
    }

```

Intuition / pattern: two completely different residuals to track. Unexplained_intraday is about **desk behaviour** (did the desk trade in/out of positions today?); PLA_residual is about **model quality** (does VaR's pricer agree with the front-office pricer?). Both should be small; the second is what FRTB's PLA test (§21) actually examines.

21. FRTB PLA test (Spearman + KS)

TL;DR: Spearman $\rho \geq 0.80$ + KS < 0.09 = GREEN. Worst zone wins. Red → desk excluded from IMA → SA capital.

What: regulator's pass/fail on whether the VaR engine's P&L matches the front-office (hypothetical) P&L closely enough over the last 12 months. **Two statistics, two thresholds.**

How it's calculated:

Over a 12-month window (≈ 250 days), collect (Hyp_PnL_t, RT_PnL_t) pairs.

Statistic 1: Spearman rank correlation ρ_s between the two series.

$\rho_s \geq 0.80 \rightarrow \text{green}$
 $0.70 \leq \rho_s < 0.80 \rightarrow \text{amber}$
 $\rho_s < 0.70 \rightarrow \text{red}$

Statistic 2: Kolmogorov-Smirnov distance $KS = \max_x |F_{\text{Hyp}}(x) - F_{\text{RT}}(x)|$

$KS < 0.09 \rightarrow \text{green}$
 $0.09 \leq KS < 0.12 \rightarrow \text{amber}$
 $KS \geq 0.12 \rightarrow \text{red}$

Joint outcome: WORST colour of the two. Red $\rightarrow$ desk excluded from IMA $\rightarrow$ SA capital.

Formula:

```
 $\rho_s = \text{corr}(\text{rank}(\text{Hyp\_PnL}), \text{rank}(\text{RT\_PnL}))$   
 $KS = \sup_x |F_{\text{Hyp}}(x) - F_{\text{RT}}(x)|$   
  
Joint colour = worst( $\{\rho_s \text{ zone}, KS \text{ zone}\}$ )
```

Toy example:

Over 250 days collect (Hyp, RT) pairs.

$\rho_s = 0.83 \rightarrow \text{green}$

$KS = 0.07 \rightarrow \text{green}$

Desk: green $\rightarrow$ eligible for IMA capital.

If model misprices a vol-of-vol exposure: ρ_s could stay 0.85 (overall direction OK)
but $KS = 0.15$ (the tail distribution diverges) $\rightarrow$ RED $\rightarrow$ SA fallback.

Canonical Python:

```
import numpy as np
from scipy.stats import spearmanr, ks_2samp

def frtb_pla(hyp_pnl: np.ndarray, rt_pnl: np.ndarray) -> dict:
    """Return Spearman + KS + zone colours per FRTB CRE 32."""
    rho, _ = spearmanr(hyp_pnl, rt_pnl)
    ks, _ = ks_2samp(hyp_pnl, rt_pnl)
    def spearman_zone(r):
        if r >= 0.80: return "GREEN"
        if r >= 0.70: return "AMBER"
        return "RED"
    def ks_zone(k):
        if k < 0.09: return "GREEN"
        if k < 0.12: return "AMBER"
        return "RED"
    order = {"GREEN": 0, "AMBER": 1, "RED": 2}
    zones = (spearman_zone(rho), ks_zone(ks))
    joint = max(zones, key=order.get)
    return {"spearman": rho, "ks": ks, "spearman_zone": zones[0],
            "ks_zone": zones[1], "joint_zone": joint}
```

Intuition / pattern: two complementary distance metrics. Spearman catches "are the rankings aligned?" — i.e., does the model rank scenarios in the same order as front-office? KS catches "are the distributions the same shape?" — i.e., does the tail match? You can pass one and fail the other.

Common failure modes: - Missing risk factor in VaR engine (e.g. forgot basis spread) $\rightarrow$ KS fails (tail shape diverges). - Different vol surface treatment $\rightarrow$ Spearman fails (rankings drift). - Pricer differences for exotics $\rightarrow$ both fail.

22. Carry / pull-to-par / theta

TL;DR: Pure time-effect P&L (no market move). Carry = expected daily; market move = surprise. Separate column on daily explain.

What: even with zero market move, a book makes/loses P&L from **time passing**: carry (running yield), pull-to-par (accrued discount/premium), theta (option time decay). Reported daily as a separate explain component.

How it's calculated:

```
Carry_t      ≈ coupon accrual per day + funding cost (repo / OIS)
Pull-to-par  ≈ (par - price) · (1/years_remaining) per day   [for bonds]
Theta        =  $\partial V / \partial t \cdot 1 \text{ day}$            [for options]
```

Total time-effect P&L = $V(t+1, \text{same market}) - V(t, \text{same market})$

Formula:

```
Time_PnL = V(market_today, t = today + 1day)
          - V(market_today, t = today)
```

```
Decomposes as:
    carry + pull-to-par + theta + cross-roll
```

Component	Sign for long position
Coupon carry	+ (you receive coupons)
Funding (repo) carry	– (you pay financing)
Pull-to-par (discount bond)	+ (price drifts up to par)
Pull-to-par (premium bond)	– (price drifts down to par)
Option theta	– (time decay; you pay for vol)

Toy example:

```
5y 4% bond, price 92.07 (discount bond).
Carry = 4 · (1/365) ≈ +0.0110 / day      (coupon accrual)
Pull-to-par ≈ (100 - 92.07)/5 · (1/365) ≈ +0.0043 / day

Long 1Y ATM call, vega = 5, σ=0.20, T=1.
Theta ≈ -V · 1/(2·T) · (1day/365) ≈ very small per day, accelerates near expiry.
```

Canonical Python:

```
def time_effect_pnl(pf, base, days_forward: int = 1):
    """Pure time-effect (no market move). Requires pricer with explicit valuation date."""
    base_t = base # valuation date = today
    base_t1 = base.advance_date(days_forward) # valuation date = today + 1d
    return pf.value(base_t1) - pf.value(base_t)
```

Intuition / pattern: separate "what would have happened anyway" from "what moved". Carry is the **expected** daily P&L; market-driven P&L is the **surprise**. A desk's Sharpe ratio is driven by getting carry > funding, not by market timing — for many fixed-income desks, weeks of patient carry get wiped out by one bad market day.

Reporting convention: time-effect appears as a separate column on the daily P&L sheet so the trader can see at a glance: `Full = Time + Market_first_order + Market_second_order + Unexplained`.

Part V — Estimation Inputs

VaR engines, sensitivity multipliers, and capital all depend on **estimated** vol, covariance, and correlation. Garbage in → garbage out. This part covers the canonical estimators and their failure modes.

23. Historical (realised) volatility

TL;DR: Rolling-window sample std. Equal weights → old shocks have same weight as today's; stale during regime shifts.

What: simple sample standard deviation of returns over a rolling window.

How it's calculated:

```
returns_t = ln(P_t / P_{t-1})      (log returns; additive across time)
σ^window = std(returns_t over last N days, ddof=1)
σ^annual = σ^daily · √252          (annualise; 252 trading days)
```

Formula:

$$\sigma^2_t = (1/(N-1)) \cdot \sum_{i=t-N+1}^t (r_i - \bar{r})^2$$
$$\sigma^{\text{annual}} = \sigma^{\text{daily}} \cdot \sqrt{252}$$

Choice	Default	Why
N window	60-250 days	trade-off: short = responsive, long = stable
log vs simple returns	log	additive across time; nearly equal for $ r < 5\%$
ddof	1	unbiased (Bessel correction)

Toy example:

```
Daily returns r = [+0.5%, -0.7%, +0.3%, ...] over N=60 days.
mean ≈ 0; std = 0.012 → σ^daily = 1.2%
σ^annual = 0.012 · √252 = 19.05%
```

Canonical Python:

```
import numpy as np

def realised_vol(prices: np.ndarray, window: int = 60, annualise: bool = True) -> float:
    """Rolling-window realised vol. Returns annualised by default."""
    r = np.diff(np.log(prices))
    sigma_daily = r[-window:].std(ddof=1)
    return sigma_daily * np.sqrt(252) if annualise else sigma_daily
```

Intuition / pattern: equally-weighted average over the window. Old observations have the same weight as today's → a single shock 200 days ago inflates today's vol the same as a shock yesterday. Solved by EWMA (§24).

24. EWMA (RiskMetrics)

TL;DR: $\sigma^2_t = \lambda \cdot \sigma^2_{t-1} + (1-\lambda) \cdot r^2_{t-1}$. RiskMetrics $\lambda=0.94$ daily; half-life 11.2d. One parameter; no mean reversion.

What: exponentially-weighted vol. Each new return updates σ^2 by a convex combination with $(1 - \lambda)$ weight, giving an EXPONENTIAL decay on past observations.

How it's calculated:

$$\sigma^2_t = \lambda \cdot \sigma^2_{t-1} + (1 - \lambda) \cdot r^2_{t-1}$$

memory of past yesterday's shock contribution
(RiskMetrics: forecast for t MADE at t-1)

Formula:

$$\sigma^2_t = \lambda \cdot \sigma^2_{t-1} + (1 - \lambda) \cdot r^2_{t-1}$$

RiskMetrics standard: $\lambda = 0.94$ (daily)
 $\lambda = 0.97$ (monthly)

Half-life and effective N:

half-life = $\ln(0.5) / \ln(\lambda)$ # days for a weight to halve
At $\lambda = 0.94$: half-life = 11.2 days, effective N $\approx$ 33 days.

Toy example:

$\sigma^2_{t-1} = 0.0001$ ($\sigma=1\%$), today $r_t = +2\%$ (a big day).
 $\sigma^2_t = 0.94 \cdot 0.0001 + 0.06 \cdot (0.02)^2 = 0.0000940 + 0.0000240 = 0.0001180$
 $\sigma^*_t = 1.086\%$ (modest update – only 6% weight on today's shock)

Canonical Python:

```
import numpy as np

def ewma_vol(returns: np.ndarray, lam: float = 0.94) -> np.ndarray:
    """EWMA conditional vol series. Returns  $\sigma^*_t$  (not  $\sigma^2$ )."""
    var = np.zeros_like(returns)
    var[0] = returns[0]**2
    for t in range(1, len(returns)):
        var[t] = lam * var[t-1] + (1 - lam) * returns[t-1]**2
    return np.sqrt(var)
```

Intuition / pattern: a single tunable parameter λ controls memory length. RiskMetrics' default $\lambda=0.94$ was estimated by JP Morgan in 1996 across major asset classes — broadly OK but **not optimal for every series**. GARCH (§25) generalises by letting both the past-vol weight AND the shock-weight be fitted.

Pitfall: EWMA assumes returns are zero-mean. Subtract the mean if $|\mu| > 0.5\sigma$, otherwise leave it.

25. GARCH(1,1)

TL;DR: $\sigma^2_t = \omega + \alpha \cdot r^2_{t-1} + \beta \cdot \sigma^2_{t-1}$. Adds mean reversion to $\sigma^2_\infty = \omega / (1 - \alpha - \beta)$. Forecast:
 $\sigma^2_{t+h} = \sigma^2_\infty + (\alpha + \beta)^h \cdot (\sigma^2_t - \sigma^2_\infty)$.

What: vol depends on yesterday's vol AND yesterday's squared return, with each having a fitted weight and a long-run constant. Captures **mean-reversion** in vol that EWMA misses.

How it's calculated:

$$\sigma^2_t = \omega + \alpha \cdot r^2_{t-1} + \beta \cdot \sigma^2_{t-1}$$

$\alpha + \beta < 1 \rightarrow$ vol mean-reverts to long-run level $\sigma^2_\infty = \omega / (1 - \alpha - \beta)$

$\alpha + \beta = 1 \rightarrow$ IGARCH (integrated GARCH, equivalent to EWMA with $\lambda = \beta$)

$\alpha + \beta > 1 \rightarrow$ non-stationary; refuse the fit.

Fit: maximum likelihood under Normal (or t) innovations. Library: `arch`.

Formula:

$$\sigma^2_t = \omega + \alpha \cdot r^2_{t-1} + \beta \cdot \sigma^2_{t-1}$$

$$\sigma^2_\infty = \omega / (1 - \alpha - \beta) \quad (\text{long-run variance})$$

$$\text{half-life} = \ln(0.5) / \ln(\alpha + \beta)$$

Toy example (typical equity fit):

$\omega = 1e-6$, $\alpha = 0.08$, $\beta = 0.90$ ($\alpha + \beta = 0.98 \rightarrow$ high persistence)

$\sigma^2_\infty = 1e-6 / 0.02 = 5e-5 \rightarrow \sigma_\infty = 0.707\%$ daily $\approx 11.2\%$ annual

half-life = $\ln(0.5) / \ln(0.98) = 34.3$ days

Multi-step forecast (this is the punchline that EWMA cannot replicate):

$$\sigma^2_{t+h | t} = \sigma^2_\infty + (\alpha + \beta)^h \cdot (\sigma^2_t - \sigma^2_\infty)$$

As $h \rightarrow \infty$: $\sigma^2_{t+h} \rightarrow \sigma^2_\infty$ (mean reversion).

At $h=10$ with $\alpha+\beta=0.98$: weight on $(\sigma^2_t - \sigma^2_\infty)$ is $0.98^{10} = 0.817$

$\rightarrow$ most of today's vol shock survives 10 days out.

EWMA: $\sigma^2_{t+h} = \sigma^2_t$ for all h (no reversion). Wrong for long-dated VaR scaling.

Canonical Python:

```
from arch import arch_model          # uv add arch
import numpy as np

def garch11_fit(returns: np.ndarray) -> dict:
    """Fit GARCH(1,1) with Normal innovations. Returns params + conditional vol series."""
    am = arch_model(returns * 100, mean="Zero", vol="GARCH", p=1, q=1, dist="normal")
    res = am.fit(dispatch="off")
    omega, alpha, beta = res.params["omega"], res.params["alpha[1]"], res.params["beta[1]"]
    return {
        "omega": omega, "alpha": alpha, "beta": beta,
        "sigma_long_run": np.sqrt(omega / (1 - alpha - beta)) / 100,
        "half_life": np.log(0.5) / np.log(alpha + beta),
        "sigma_t": res.conditional_volatility / 100,
    }
```

Intuition / pattern: three parameters generalising EWMA. The big improvement over EWMA: vol forecasts mean-revert. σ^2_{t+h} converges to σ^2_∞ as $h \rightarrow \infty$, with rate $(\alpha + \beta)^h$. EWMA's forecast stays constant at σ^2_t for any horizon — wrong for long-dated VaR.

Extensions: - **GJR-GARCH** (`vol="GARCH", o=1`): asymmetric — negative returns ramp up vol more than positive (leverage effect). - **EGARCH**: log-variance $\rightarrow$ no positivity constraint, captures asymmetry. - **Student-t innovations** (`dist="t"`): fattens tails.

25b. DCC-GARCH + tail-dependence copulas

TL;DR: DCC = time-varying correlations; t-copula = non-zero tail dependence. Closes the 'diversification fails in crisis' gap that Gaussian copula leaves.

What: univariate GARCH (§25) gives **time-varying volatility** but assumes correlations are constant. **DCC-GARCH** (Engle 2002) lets the correlation matrix R_t evolve over time — captures the "correlations $\rightarrow$ 1 in stress" effect that destroys diversification when you need it most. **Copulas** (Gaussian, Student-t, Archimedean) model the **dependence structure** separately from marginals, capturing **tail dependence** that linear correlation misses.

How DCC is calculated:

1. Fit univariate GARCH(1,1) per asset $\rightarrow \hat{\sigma}_i^2, t$ and standardised residuals $z_i, t = r_i, t / \hat{\sigma}_i, t$.
2. $Q_t = (1 - \alpha - \beta) \cdot \hat{Q} + \alpha \cdot z_{t-1} z_{t-1}^T + \beta \cdot Q_{t-1}$

long-run target
shock
memory
3. $R_t = \text{diag}(Q_t)^{-\frac{1}{2}} \cdot Q_t \cdot \text{diag}(Q_t)^{-\frac{1}{2}}$ (normalise to correlation)
4. $\Sigma_t = D_t \cdot R_t \cdot D_t$ where $D_t = \text{diag}(\hat{\sigma}_i^2, t)$

Copula models (dependence $\perp$ marginals via Sklar's theorem):

$$F(x_1, \dots, x_n) = C(F_1(x_1), \dots, F_n(x_n)) \quad (\text{joint CDF} = \text{copula of marginal CDFs})$$

Gaussian copula: $C(u) = \Phi(R(\Phi^{-1}(u_1), \dots, \Phi^{-1}(u_n)))$ NO tail dependence.

Student-t copula: adds ν degrees-of-freedom $\rightarrow$ upper AND lower tail dependence $\uparrow$ as $\nu \downarrow$.

Clayton (Archim): lower tail dependence only (good for credit default).

Gumbel (Archim): upper tail dependence only (joint upside surprises).

Tail-dependence coefficient:

$$\lambda_{\text{lower}} = \lim_{q \rightarrow 0} P[X_1 \leq F_1^{-1}(q) \mid X_2 \leq F_2^{-1}(q)]$$

$$\lambda_{\text{upper}} = \lim_{q \rightarrow 1} P[X_1 > F_1^{-1}(q) \mid X_2 > F_2^{-1}(q)]$$

Gaussian: $\lambda_{\text{lower}} = \lambda_{\text{upper}} = 0$ (asymptotic independence – diversification "wins" in extremes – counterfactual!)

Student-t(ν): $\lambda_{\text{lower}} = \lambda_{\text{upper}} = 2 \cdot T_{\{ \nu+1 \}}(-\sqrt{((\nu+1)(1-\rho)/(1+\rho))})$ (positive for any $\nu < \infty$)

Clayton(θ): λ lower = $2^{-1/\theta}$, λ upper = 0

Formula:

DCC: R_t evolves; $\Sigma_t = D_t R_t D_t$

Copula: joint = C(marginals) – Sklar's theorem

Student-t / Clayton copulas have $\lambda > 0$ in tails

Toy example (Gaussian vs t-copula MC VaR):

Same marginals (each $\sim N(0,1)$), $\rho = 0.5$.

1-day VaR(99%) of equal-weight 2-asset portfolio:

Gaussian copula MC: $\text{VaR} \approx 1.61$

t-copula ($\nu=4$) MC:	Var ≈ 2.05	(28% higher because tail-dep means joint extremes)
--------------------------	--------------------	--

t-copula (v=8) MC:	VaR $\approx$ 1.81
--------------------	--------------------

Canonical Python (DCC via `mgarch`; copula via `copulas` or `statsmodels`):

```
# DCC: production uses dedicated packages (mgarch, rmgarch (R), bekkpy)
# Sketch – fit per-asset GARCH, then DCC:
from arch import arch_model
import numpy as np

def standardised_residuals(returns: np.ndarray) -> np.ndarray:
    """Per-asset GARCH → standardised innovation series, ready for DCC or copula fit."""
    Z = np.zeros_like(returns)
    for i in range(returns.shape[1]):
        res = arch_model(returns[:, i] * 100, vol="GARCH", p=1, q=1).fit(dis="off")
        Z[:, i] = returns[:, i] / (res.conditional_volatility / 100)
    return Z

# Student-t copula calibration:
from scipy.stats import t, kendalltau
def t_copula_calibrate(Z: np.ndarray, nu_grid=(3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 12)) -> tuple[float, np.ndarray]:
    """Coarse t-copula calibration: rank-correlation matrix + ν via likelihood grid."""
    U = (Z.argsort(axis=0).argsort(axis=0) + 1) / (Z.shape[0] + 1) # rank to (0,1)
    R = np.corrcoef(t.ppf(U, df=nu_grid[0]), rowvar=False)
    # full implementation: MLE on (R, ν) – see scikit-learn-extra or `copulas` lib
    return nu_grid[0], R
```

Intuition / pattern: decouple marginals from dependence. Standard VaR / mean-variance implicitly use a Gaussian copula (zero tail-dependence) — empirically wrong. Switch to t-copula for **any** equity/credit/multi-asset VaR engine that needs to handle the "everything fell together" days. DCC for time-varying correlation under regime shifts.

When to use: - Cross-asset VaR / capital → t-copula (tail dependence). - Default risk on a portfolio of names → Clayton (lower-tail). - Regime-changing market → DCC-GARCH. - Marginals fat-tailed but dependence Gaussian → calibrate marginals empirically, then plug into Gaussian copula.

26. Implied volatility

TL;DR: Solve σ s.t. $BS(\sigma) = \text{market_price}$. Brent root-find (not Newton) for robustness near boundaries. Vol surface = IV across strikes × expiries.

What: the σ that makes a Black-Scholes (or Black-76) price match an observed market option price.

Forward-looking — embeds the market's view of future vol.

How it's calculated:

```
Solve for  $\sigma$ :    market_price = BS(S, K, T, r,  $\sigma$ , ...)
                    ▲
Numerical: Newton-Raphson on  $f(\sigma) = BS(\sigma) - \text{market\_price}$ ;  $f'(\sigma) = \text{vega}$ .
Initial guess:  $\sigma_0 = \sqrt{2\pi/T} \cdot |\text{market\_price}| / S$  (Brenner-Subrahmanyam)
```

Formula (the inversion):

```
Find  $\sigma$  such that  $BS\_price(\sigma) = \text{mkt\_price}$ 

Newton step:  $\sigma_{\{n+1\}} = \sigma_n - (BS(\sigma_n) - \text{mkt}) / \text{vega}(\sigma_n)$ 

Convergence:  $|BS(\sigma) - \text{mkt}| < \text{tol}$  (typically  $1e-8$ )
```

Toy example:

```
S=100, K=100, T=1, r=0.04, q=0, observed call price = 10.45.
BS at  $\sigma=0.20$ : 9.41 → too low, increase  $\sigma$ 
BS at  $\sigma=0.25$ : 11.69 → too high, decrease  $\sigma$ 
BS at  $\sigma=0.224$ : 10.45 ✓ → IV = 22.4%
```

Canonical Python:

```

import numpy as np
from scipy.optimize import brentq
from scipy.stats import norm

def bs_call(S, K, T, r, sigma, q=0.0):
    d1 = (np.log(S/K) + (r - q + 0.5*sigma**2)*T) / (sigma*np.sqrt(T))
    d2 = d1 - sigma*np.sqrt(T)
    return S*np.exp(-q*T)*norm.cdf(d1) - K*np.exp(-r*T)*norm.cdf(d2)

def implied_vol(market_price, S, K, T, r, q=0.0, is_call=True) -> float:
    """Brent root-find – more robust than Newton at the boundaries."""
    if not is_call:
        f = lambda v: bs_call(S, K, T, r, v, q) - (S - K*np.exp(-r*T)) - market_price # put via parity
    else:
        f = lambda v: bs_call(S, K, T, r, v, q) - market_price
    return brentq(f, 1e-6, 5.0, xtol=1e-8)

```

Intuition / pattern: the market's price translated into vol units. A vol surface (IV across all strikes × expiries) is the canonical "vol object" used by trading desks — far richer than a single realised number. Smile/skew shapes encode tail-risk pricing.

Pitfalls: - Very deep OTM options → very small price → IV can explode numerically. - Newton can fail near the boundary; **use Brent's method** for robustness. - Always check `market_price > intrinsic_value`; otherwise no real IV exists.

27. Sample covariance

TL;DR: `cov(R, rowvar=False, ddof=1)`. Gold standard ONLY when $T \gg N$; singular when $T < N$.

What: per-pair sample covariance of asset returns, assembled into an $N \times N$ matrix.

How it's calculated:

R : $T \times N$ matrix of returns (T days, N assets).
 $\hat{\mu} = \text{mean}(R, \text{axis}=0)$ (length- N)
 $\hat{\Sigma} = (1/(T-1)) \cdot (R - \hat{\mu})^T (R - \hat{\mu})$ ($N \times N$)

Formula:

$$\hat{\Sigma}_{\{ij\}} = (1/(T-1)) \cdot \sum_t (r_{\{t,i\}} - \hat{\mu}_i)(r_{\{t,j\}} - \hat{\mu}_j)$$

Equivalently: `$\hat{\Sigma} = \text{cov}(R, \text{rowvar=False}, \text{ddof}=1)$`

Toy example:

$T=250$, $N=3$ assets.
`np.cov(R, rowvar=False)` → 3×3 symmetric PSD matrix.
`diag( $\hat{\Sigma}$ )` = per-asset sample variance.
 off-diag = pairwise covariances; correlations = $\hat{\Sigma}_{ij} / (\sigma_i \cdot \sigma_j)$.

Canonical Python:

```

import numpy as np

def sample_cov(returns: np.ndarray) -> np.ndarray:
    """returns shape (T, N). Bessel-corrected, PSD by construction (when T > N)."""
    return np.cov(returns, rowvar=False, ddof=1)

```

Intuition / pattern: gold standard ONLY when $T \gg N$. When $T < N$ (more assets than days), the sample covariance is **singular** ($\text{rank} \leq T-1$) → can't invert → can't compute parametric VaR / mean-variance weights. Solved by shrinkage (§28).

Pitfalls: - Time-varying covariance: sample assumes stationary; use EWMA-covariance or DCC-GARCH if vol regimes shift. - Outlier sensitivity: a single crash day in the window inflates all variances. - Look-ahead bias: never include returns from after your evaluation date.

28. Ledoit-Wolf shrinkage

TL;DR: $\Sigma_{\text{shrink}} = \delta \cdot F + (1-\delta) \cdot S$, δ fitted to minimise MSE. Regularises when $N \approx T$; standard fix for parametric VaR / mean-variance with limited history.

What: shrink the **noisy sample covariance** toward a **structured target** (constant correlation, identity, or single-factor) by a fitted weight δ . Reduces estimation error, makes the matrix invertible even when $T < N$.

How it's calculated:

$$\Sigma_{\text{shrink}} = \underset{\text{target matrix}}{\delta} \cdot F + \underset{\text{sample covariance}}{(1 - \delta)} \cdot S$$

F is the **shrinkage target** — most common choices: - **Identity scaled:** $F = (\text{tr}(S)/N) \cdot I$ (zero correlations, equal variances). - **Constant correlation:** average pairwise correlation $\rightarrow$ all off-diag get the same ρ .

δ is fitted to **minimise expected MSE** between Σ_{shrink} and the true Σ ; closed-form formula in Ledoit & Wolf (2004).

Formula (Ledoit-Wolf optimal δ , full form):

$$\begin{aligned} \delta^* &= \max(0, \min(1, (\pi - \rho) / (T \cdot \gamma))) \\ \pi &= \sum_{i,j} \text{Var}(S_{ij}) \quad (\text{sample-cov estimation noise}) \\ \rho &= \sum_{i,j} \text{Cov}(S_{ij}, F_{ij}) \quad (\text{sample-target covariance}) \\ \gamma &= \|F - \Sigma\|_F^2 = \sum_{i,j} (F_{ij} - E[S_{ij}])^2 \quad (\text{model bias}) \\ \text{Identity target} &\Rightarrow \rho \approx 0 \Rightarrow \delta^* \approx \pi / (T \cdot \gamma) \end{aligned}$$

Toy example:

$T=60$ days, $N=100$ stocks. Sample cov has rank $\leq 59 \rightarrow$ singular.
Shrink toward $(\text{tr}(S)/100) \cdot I$. Fitted $\delta = 0.45$.
 $\Sigma_{\text{shrink}} = 0.45 \cdot F + 0.55 \cdot S \rightarrow$ full rank, well-conditioned.

Canonical Python:

```
from sklearn.covariance import LedoitWolf # uv add scikit-learn
import numpy as np

def ledoit_wolf_cov(returns: np.ndarray) -> tuple[np.ndarray, float]:
    """Shrink sample cov toward (tr(N)·I. Returns (Σ_shrunk, shrinkage_intensity δ)."""
    lw = LedoitWolf().fit(returns)
    return lw.covariance_, float(lw.shrinkage_)
```

Intuition / pattern: regularisation for covariance matrices. Δ near 0 $\rightarrow$ trust the sample; Δ near 1 $\rightarrow$ trust the target. Typical Δ for daily equity factor returns: 0.1–0.4. Always check $\text{eigvals}(\Sigma_{\text{shrink}}) > 0$ after fitting.

When to use: - N (assets) $\sim T$ (days) — sample is noisy. - Need Σ^{-1} for mean-variance, parametric VaR, MVaR. - Bayesian-flavoured "blend prior with data" framing.

29. PSD repair (eigenvalue clipping)

What: a sample correlation matrix should be **positive semi-definite** (PSD: all eigenvalues ≥ 0). Real data often produces small **NEGATIVE** eigenvalues (numerical noise, missing data, regulator-mandated bumps). Fix by clipping.

How it's calculated:

```
1. Eigen-decompose:   $\Sigma = Q \Lambda Q^T$ 
2. Clip:              $\Lambda' = \text{diag}(\max(\lambda_i, \epsilon))$        $\epsilon$  small (e.g.  $1e-8$ )
3. Reconstruct:       $\Sigma_{\text{psd}} = Q \Lambda' Q^T$ 
4. (Optional) Rescale to preserve diagonal:   $D = \text{diag}(\sqrt{\text{diag}(\Sigma) / \text{diag}(\Sigma_{\text{psd}})})$ 
                                                 $\Sigma_{\text{final}} = D \Sigma_{\text{psd}} D$ 
```

Formula:

```
 $\Sigma = Q \Lambda Q^T$ 
 $\Lambda' = \text{diag}(\max(\lambda_i, \epsilon))$ 
 $\Sigma_{\text{psd}} = Q \Lambda' Q^T$  (PSD; diagonal may drift)
 $\Sigma_{\text{final}} = D \Sigma_{\text{psd}} D$  to restore unit diagonal
```

Toy example:

3-asset correlation matrix from data:

```
[1.00  0.85  0.75]
[0.85  1.00  0.95]
[0.75  0.95  1.00]
```

```
eigenvalues = [2.692, 0.323, -0.015]  ← tiny negative → NOT PSD
Clip negative to  $1e-8$  → reconstruct → PSD ✓ with off-diagonals barely changed.
```

Canonical Python:

```
import numpy as np

def nearest_psd(M: np.ndarray, eps: float = 1e-8) -> np.ndarray:
    """Clip negative eigenvalues to eps. Symmetrise. Rescale diagonal to preserve variances."""
    M_sym = 0.5 * (M + M.T)
    vals, vecs = np.linalg.eigh(M_sym)
    vals = np.clip(vals, eps, None)
    M_psd = vecs @ np.diag(vals) @ vecs.T
    d = np.sqrt(np.diag(M) / np.diag(M_psd).clip(eps))
    return d[:, None] * M_psd * d[None, :]
```

Intuition / pattern: a covariance matrix that isn't PSD breaks downstream code — `chol` fails, parametric VaR can return imaginary numbers, MVO can produce wild leverage. Clip-and-rescale is the **standard fix**. More principled alternatives: Higham's nearest-correlation-matrix algorithm (iterative projection).

Conditioning warning: clipping to $\epsilon=1e-8$ makes the matrix technically PSD but may leave it **ill-conditioned** for Σ^{-1} (mean-variance, MVar). If you need to invert, clip to a higher floor ($\sim 1e-4 \cdot \lambda_{\text{max}}$) or use Higham.

29b. Liquidity-Adjusted VaR (LVaR)

TL;DR: $\text{VaR} + \frac{1}{2} \cdot |\text{pos}| \cdot (\mu_{\text{BAS}} + k \cdot \sigma_{\text{BAS}})$ — adds bid-ask cost. Horizon-scaled: $\sqrt{h} \cdot \text{VaR}_1$ for forced multi-day liquidation.

What: standard VaR ignores **transaction cost** and **liquidation horizon**. A position you can't unwind in one day has more risk than the daily-VaR suggests. LVaR adds two corrections: **(a) bid-ask spread cost** and **(b) extended-horizon vol**.

How it's calculated (Bangia-Diebold-Schuermann decomposition):

$$\text{LVaR}(\alpha) = \text{VaR}(\alpha) + \frac{1}{2} \cdot |\text{position}| \cdot (\mu_{\text{BAS}} + k \cdot \sigma_{\text{BAS}})$$

where: μ_{BAS} = mean relative bid-ask spread (e.g. 0.0010 for 10bp)

σ_{BAS} = std of relative bid-ask spread

k = quantile (e.g. 3 for 99%, normal assumption)

The $\frac{1}{2}$ factor: you only cross HALF the spread on liquidation (mid $\rightarrow$ bid).

Horizon-adjusted LVaR (when h-day liquidation, not 1-day):

$$\text{LVaR}_h(\alpha) = \sqrt{h} \cdot \text{VaR}_1(\alpha) + \text{liquidation_cost}$$

For non-trivial gamma: also add $\frac{1}{2} \cdot \Gamma \cdot (\sqrt{h} \cdot \sigma)^2$ (convexity over the longer horizon).

Formula:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{LVaR} &= \text{VaR_market_risk} + \text{LiquidationCost} \\ &= z(\alpha) \cdot \sigma + \frac{1}{2} \cdot |\text{pos}| \cdot (\mu_{\text{BAS}} + k \cdot \sigma_{\text{BAS}}) \end{aligned}$$

For h-day forced liquidation:

$$\text{LVaR}_h = \sqrt{h} \cdot \text{VaR}_1 + \text{LiquidationCost}$$

Toy example:

Position size = \$10M. Asset $\sigma_{\text{daily}} = 1\% \rightarrow$ standard $\text{VaR}(99\%) = 2.326 \cdot 1\% \cdot \$10\text{M} = \$232.6\text{k}$.

Bid-ask spread: $\mu_{\text{BAS}} = 5\text{bp}$ (0.0005), $\sigma_{\text{BAS}} = 2\text{bp}$ (0.0002), $k = 3$.

Liquidation cost = $\frac{1}{2} \cdot \$10\text{M} \cdot (0.0005 + 3 \cdot 0.0002) = \frac{1}{2} \cdot \$10\text{M} \cdot 0.0011 = \$5,500$.

$\text{LVaR}(99\%) = \$232,600 + \$5,500 = \$238,100$. (2.4% uplift – modest for liquid asset)

Same position in an emerging-market asset, $\text{BAS } \mu = 50\text{bp}$, $\sigma = 20\text{bp}$:

Liquidation cost = $\frac{1}{2} \cdot \$10\text{M} \cdot (0.005 + 3 \cdot 0.002) = \$55,000$. $\text{LVaR} = \$287,600$ (24% uplift).

Canonical Python:

```
import numpy as np
from scipy.stats import norm

def lvar_bangia(var_daily: float, position: float,
               bas_mean: float, bas_std: float, conf: float = 0.99) -> float:
    """Bangia-Diebold-Schuermann LVaR. var_daily = market-risk VaR. BAS in decimal (50bp = 0.0005)."""
    k = norm.ppf(conf)
    liq_cost = 0.5 * abs(position) * (bas_mean + k * bas_std)
    return var_daily + liq_cost

def lvar_horizon(var_1day: float, h_days: int, liq_cost: float) -> float:
    """Forced-liquidation LVaR scaling. iid-normal assumption – fails under autocorrelation."""
    return np.sqrt(h_days) * var_1day + liq_cost
```

Intuition / pattern: two distinct frictions to add to VaR. (a) bid-ask cost is a deterministic levy on the position size — small for liquid futures, huge for illiquid OTC. (b) horizon scaling penalises positions that can't be unwound quickly — FRTB IMA bakes this in via per-factor LH (§37); BDS LVaR is the pre-FRTB shorthand many desks still use as a single overlay.

Limits: assumes the BAS distribution is stationary (false in crises — spreads blow out 10×); doesn't capture **market impact** (selling large size moves the price). For impact: add a $\lambda \cdot |q|^\alpha$ term (Almgren-Chriss).

Part VI — Stress & Scenarios

VaR captures **the distribution of normal-day moves**. Stress testing answers the complementary question: "**what if a specific historical/hypothetical bad day happens?**" — a single deterministic scenario, full-revalued.

30. Historical scenarios

TL;DR: Named events replayed: Black Monday, LTCM, Lehman, COVID, Gilt 2022. Single deterministic shock vector, full-revalue.

What: replay specific named events. Standard library:

Scenario	Period	Key factor moves
Black Monday 1987	1987-10-19	S&P -22%, vol up 200%
Russian default / LTCM	1998-08 to 1998-10	EMBI +800bp, US Treasury 10y -150bp (flight)
9/11 reopen	2001-09-17	S&P -5%, USTs flight, energy +10%
Lehman week	2008-09-15 to 2008-09-19	Libor-OIS +200bp, S&P -12%, USTs -80bp, gold +5%
March 2020 (COVID)	2020-03-09 to 2020-03-23	S&P -34%, VIX 80, USTs -50bp, IG +250bp, HY +600bp
Sept 2022 (gilt LDI crisis)	2022-09-23 to 2022-09-28	30y UK gilt +120bp in 3 days, GBP -5%, LDI funds margin-called

How it's calculated:

For each named scenario:

1. Look up the factor shocks observed during the event.
2. Full-reval the current book under those shocks.
3. Report scenario P&L = $V(\text{shocked}) - V(\text{base})$.

Toy example (Lehman week scenario on a 5y vanilla bond):

Lehman week shocks: rate -80bp, credit_spread +200bp
Bond DV01 = 0.0425, CS01 = 0.0425
Linear P&L $\approx (-0.0425) \cdot (-80) + (-0.0425) \cdot (+200) = 3.40 - 8.50 = -5.10$
Full-reval P&L (drill 8 portfolio): slightly different due to convexity.

Canonical Python:

```
HISTORICAL_SCENARIOS = {
    "lehman_week": {"rate_bp": -80, "spread_bp": +200, "vol_shock": +0.10, "fx_shock": +0.03},
    "covid_march": {"rate_bp": -50, "spread_bp": +250, "vol_shock": +0.40, "fx_shock": -0.05},
    "gilt_2022": {"rate_bp": +120, "spread_bp": +30, "vol_shock": +0.20, "fx_shock": -0.05},
}

def scenario_pnl(pf, base, scenario_name: str) -> float:
    shocks = HISTORICAL_SCENARIOS[scenario_name]
    return pf.value(Scenario(**shocks).apply(base)) - pf.value(base)
```

Intuition / pattern: a single deterministic factor vector applied as a shock. Doesn't replace VaR — complements it. VaR says "1 in 100 days I lose at least \$X"; scenario says "if Lehman happens again, I lose \$Y, EXACTLY".

Calibration sources: scenario shocks should be measured from the event window (peak-to-trough for risk-off, day-of-shock for fast moves). Don't average over the recovery — that dilutes the shock.

31. Hypothetical scenarios

TL;DR: Forward-looking templates (parallel shift, steepener, blowout, vol spike). Solvency II SCR is a prescribed library of these.

What: forward-looking shocks based on **plausible but unobserved** events. Used for what-if analysis, capital planning, ICAAP/Solvency II reverse stress.

Common templates:

Scenario	Description	Standard shocks
Parallel shift	yield curve $\pm 100\text{bp}$	rate_bp = ± 100 , others flat
Steepener / flattener	2s10s	2y +25bp, 10y +50bp / 2y +50bp, 10y +25bp
Bull/bear flattener	rate AND direction	bull flat = 2y unchanged, 10y -50bp ; bear flat = 2y +50bp, 10y unchanged
Credit blowout	IG +200bp / HY +500bp	spread_bp by credit bucket
Vol spike	implied vol +50% relative	vol_shock = $0.5 \cdot \text{base_vol}$
FX 3σ	DX $\pm 10\%$	fx_shock = ± 0.10
Combined risk-off	rate -50bp , IG +100bp, vol +30%, equity -20%	multi-factor

Canonical Python:

```
HYPOTHETICAL_SCENARIOS = {
    "parallel_+100": {"rate_bp": 100},
    "parallel_-100": {"rate_bp": -100},
    "bear_steepener": {"rate_2y_bp": 25, "rate_10y_bp": 50},
    "bull_flattener": {"rate_2y_bp": 0, "rate_10y_bp": -50},
    "vol_spike_50pct": {"vol_shock": 0.10},      # absolute uplift assuming base  $\sigma \approx 20\%$ 
    "risk_off": {"rate_bp": -50, "spread_bp": 100, "vol_shock": 0.06, "fx_shock": -0.05},
}

# apply via the same scenario_pnl(pf, base, name) as historical
```

Intuition / pattern: stress isn't VaR. VaR is statistical; stress is **stylised**. Use both. The Solvency II SCR for market risk uses **prescribed 1-in-200-year hypothetical shocks** (rate $\pm 62\text{bp}$ at 1y, equity -39% , spread $\pm 100\text{bp}$ for AAA $\rightarrow$ +750bp for unrated, FX $\pm 25\%$) — calibrated to historical 99.5% but applied as deterministic stresses.

32. Reverse stress test

TL;DR: Find the cheapest (Mahalanobis-minimal) factor shock producing target loss L^* . ICAAP/Pillar 2 requirement.

What: instead of "what's my P&L given this scenario?", ask "**what scenario produces a P&L of $-\$X$?**" where X = critical loss threshold (e.g. regulatory capital, going-concern boundary).

How it's calculated:

Choose target loss L^* . Find a scenario s^* such that:

1. $PnL(s^*) = -L^*$ (loss equals target)
2. s^* is "plausible" (e.g., Mahalanobis distance $\leq k$)
3. s^* minimises distance to current market state

Solve:

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{minimise } s^T \Sigma^{-1} s && \text{(Mahalanobis distance}^2\text{)} \\ &\text{subject to } PnL(s) = -L^* \end{aligned}$$

For a linear book: closed-form via Lagrange.

$$\begin{aligned} \lambda &= -L^* / (sens^T \cdot \Sigma \cdot sens) && \text{(Lagrange multiplier; negative for a LOSS)} \\ s^* &= \lambda \cdot \Sigma \cdot sens && \text{(shock vector)} \\ \text{Mahalanobis dist} &= \sqrt{(s^{*T} \Sigma^{-1} s^*)} = L^* / \sigma_{pnl} \end{aligned}$$

Toy example (drill 13 portfolio, find scenario that loses 10):

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma_{pnl} &= 2.5327, \text{ sens} = [s_rate, s_spread, s_vol, s_fx] \\ \lambda &= -10 / \sigma_{pnl}^2 = -10 / 6.414 = -1.559 \\ s^* &= -1.559 \cdot \Sigma \cdot sens \end{aligned}$$

(numerically): roughly proportional to the "worst-direction" eigenvector of $\Sigma \times sens$.
Mahalanobis dist = $10 / 2.5327 = 3.95\sigma \leftarrow \sim 3.95$ -sigma event in factor space.

Canonical Python (linear, closed-form):

```
import numpy as np

def reverse_stress_linear(target_loss: float, sens: np.ndarray, cov: np.ndarray):
    """Find the smallest (Mahalanobis) factor shock that produces target_loss for a LINEAR book."""
    pnl_var = sens @ cov @ sens
    lam = -target_loss / pnl_var
    s_star = lam * (cov @ sens)
    mahalanobis = np.sqrt(s_star @ np.linalg.inv(cov) @ s_star)
    return s_star, mahalanobis
```

Intuition / pattern: "find the cheapest way to lose \$X". The answer points to the **factor combination you're most exposed to**: a hedged book has a HIGH Mahalanobis distance for a given loss (you'd need a freak combination of shocks); a concentrated book has a LOW one (one obvious bad scenario destroys you).

Regulatory use: PRA / Fed / EBA all require reverse stress as part of ICAAP. Banks must publish: "what scenario takes us below CET1 minimum?" The plausibility threshold is qualitative — defended in writing.

33. Aggregating scenario P&L

TL;DR: Report the WORST scenario + the full TABLE. DON'T sum/average — double-counts shared shocks (Lehman + COVID both contain equity drop).

Problem: you run 20 different scenarios. How do you summarise?

Approaches:

- | | | |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. WORST SCENARIO: | max over scenarios of $ PnL $. | Single number. |
| 2. CORRELATED SUM: | $\sum s_w s \cdot PnL_s $ | Weighted by likelihood. |
| 3. DASHBOARD (no aggregation): | table of all 20 scenario P&Ls. | Just look at it. |

Aggregation pitfall: scenarios are NOT independent draws from a distribution. Adding their losses **double-counts shared shocks** — Lehman week and COVID both contain a large equity drop; sum implies the equity shock happens twice. **Don't average / sum** scenario P&Ls; **report the table**.

Reporting convention (typical for trading desk):

Scenario	P&L (\$)	Main driver
Lehman week	−5.10	credit spread +200bp
COVID March	−7.85	vol +40% on long-gamma book
Gilt 2022	+1.20	short-duration book benefits from rate rise
Parallel +100	−2.45	linear DV01
Bear steepener	−1.85	KRD-10y > KRD-2y
Worst loss	−7.85	COVID March

Why averaging double-counts: many scenarios share factor shocks. Lehman (S&P −12%) and COVID (S&P −34%) both load on the equity shock; adding their P&Ls implies the equity move happens TWICE. Same for the credit-spread move present in both Lehman and COVID. Sum-of-scenarios overstates true tail loss by 50-200% on a multi-asset book.

Intuition / pattern: the worst-case number is the summary; the table is the analysis. Senior management gets the worst number; the trading desk gets the table to know which scenario is biting and why.

Part VII — Capital Frameworks

Regulatory market-risk capital sits on top of all the methods above. Two frameworks live in parallel: **Basel SA-CCR** (counterparty exposure) and **FRTB** (market-risk capital, replacing Basel 2.5 IMA + SA from January 2025).

34. Basel SA-CCR

TL;DR: $EAD = 1.4 \cdot (RC + PFE)$. Replaces CEM. Counterparty exposure for OTC + SFTs; feeds CCR-RWA.

What: Standardised Approach for Counterparty Credit Risk — replaces CEM (Current Exposure Method). Computes **EAD** (Exposure at Default) for OTC derivatives netting sets and SFTs.

How it's calculated:

```
EAD = α · (RC + PFE)          α = 1.4 (regulatory multiplier)
RC = max(V - C, 0)             Replacement Cost; V = MtM, C = net collateral
PFE = aggregate add-on per asset class × multiplier

multiplier = min(1, floor + (1 - floor) · exp((V - C) / (2 · aggregate_add_on)))
```

Formula:

```
EAD = 1.4 · ( RC + PFE )

RC = max(V - C, 0)
PFE = mult · Σ_AsetClass AddOn_AC
mult = min(1, 0.05 + 0.95·exp((V-C)/(2·Σ AddOn)))
```

Toy example:

```
Net MtM V = $10M; collateral C = $5M → RC = $5M
IR add-on aggregated = $20M; FX add-on = $5M → Σ = $25M
multiplier = min(1, 0.05 + 0.95·exp(5/50)) = min(1, 0.05 + 0.95·1.105) = 1.0
PFE = 1.0 · 25 = $25M
EAD = 1.4 · (5 + 25) = $42M
```

Canonical Python (illustrative — production has dozens of edge cases):

```
import math

def sa_ccr_ead(mtm: float, collateral: float, addons: dict[str, float]) -> float:
    """Simplified SA-CCR EAD. addons is per asset-class aggregated add-on ($)."""
    rc = max(mtm - collateral, 0)
    total_addon = sum(addons.values())
    mult = min(1.0, 0.05 + 0.95 * math.exp((mtm - collateral) / (2 * max(total_addon, 1e-6))))
    pfe = mult * total_addon
    return 1.4 * (rc + pfe)
```

Intuition / pattern: $EAD \approx \text{today's MtM} + \text{future drift}$. Replaces the very crude "notional × supervisory factor" of CEM with **asset-class add-ons sensitive to maturity, delta, and supervisory factors**. EAD then feeds the **counterparty risk-weighted asset (RWA)** calc.

35. Basel IMA (legacy)

TL;DR: $MRC = \max(\text{VaR}_t, k \cdot \text{avg}_{60} \text{VaR}) + \max(\text{sVaR}_t, k \cdot \text{avg}_{60} \text{sVaR})$. Phased out by FRTB Jan 2025.

What: Basel II.5 Internal Models Approach — the old VaR-based market-risk capital, phased out by FRTB IMA in 2025 but still relevant for legacy systems and emerging-market regulators.

How it's calculated:

$$\text{Market_Risk_Charge} = \max(\text{VaR}_t, k_{\text{VaR}} \cdot \text{VaR}_{\text{avg_60d}}) + \max(s\text{VaR}_t, k_{s\text{VaR}} \cdot s\text{VaR}_{\text{avg_60d}})$$

general VaR (99%, 10-day)stressed VaR (II.5 addition)

k VaR, k sVaR ∈ [3.0, 4.0] (traffic-light, §11)

Formula:

$MRC_legacy = \max(VaR_t, k \cdot avg_{60}(VaR)) + \max(sVaR_t, k \cdot avg_{60}(sVaR))$
Plus: IRC (incremental risk charge) + CRM (comprehensive risk)

Toy example:

$\text{VaR}_t = \$50\text{M}$, $\text{avg60_VaR} = \$48\text{M}$, $k_{\text{VaR}} = 3.0$ (green) $\rightarrow$ charge = $\max(50, 144) = \$144\text{M}$
 $\text{sVaR}_t = \$80\text{M}$, $\text{avg60_sVaR} = \$75\text{M}$, $k_{\text{sVaR}} = 3.0$ $\rightarrow$ charge = $\max(80, 225) = \$225\text{M}$
 $\text{MRC legacy} = \$144\text{M} + \$225\text{M} = \$369\text{M}$

Intuition / pattern: VaR is the foundation; sVaR forces memory of 2008; multiplier penalises poor backtests. Replaced because: (a) VaR not coherent, (b) tail beyond 99% unmeasured, (c) capital can fall during calm markets even if balance-sheet risk hasn't.

36. FRTB SA (Sensitivities-Based Method)

TL;DR: TWO-level sensitivity aggregation: within-bucket K_b, across-bucket Delta. Three correlation scenarios (low/med/high), take max.

What: Standardised Approach under Fundamental Review of the Trading Book. Sensitivity-based — bank computes **delta, vega, curvature** per regulator-defined bucket, applies prescribed risk weights and correlations, sums to capital.

Three components (two-level aggregation per risk class):

$$\text{SBM Capital} = \sum \text{RiskClass} [\text{Delta} + \text{Vega} + \text{Curvature}]$$

Delta:

WITHIN bucket b: $K_b = \sqrt{(\sum_i WS_i^2 + \sum_{i \neq j} \rho_{ij} \cdot WS_i \cdot WS_j)}$
 $WS_i = RW_i \cdot s_i$ (risk-weighted sensitivity per factor in bucket b)
 ρ_{ij} = WITHIN-bucket correlation (prescribed)

ACROSS buckets:

$$\Delta = \sqrt{(\sum_b K_b^2 + \sum_{\{b \neq c\}} \gamma_{bc} \cdot S_b \cdot S_c)}$$

$$S_b = \sum_i WS_i \quad (\text{signed sum over factors in bucket } b)$$

$$\gamma_{bc} = \text{ACROSS-bucket correlation (prescribed)}$$

Vega: Same TWO-LEVEL structure on vega sensitivities; buckets per maturity $\times$ moneyness.

Curvature:
$$\begin{aligned} \text{CVR_k_up} &= -[V(+RW \cdot \text{risk-factor shock}) - V(\text{base}) - RW \cdot \text{delta}] \quad (\text{LOSS, signed +}) \\ \text{CVR_k_down} &= -[V(-RW \cdot \text{risk-factor shock}) - V(\text{base}) + RW \cdot \text{delta}] \\ \text{K_b_curv} &= \sqrt{(\sum_b \max(\text{CVR_up_b}, \text{CVR_down_b})^2)} \text{ within bucket; then across-bucket} \\ &\text{aggregation analogous to Delta with curvature correlations.} \end{aligned}$$

THREE CORRELATION SCENARIOS: banks compute Delta/Vega/Curvature under low ($\times 0.75$), medium ($\times 1.00$), and high ($\times 1.25$) correlation scaling – take MAX across scenarios.

Plus: Default Risk Charge (DRC), Residual Risk Add-On (RRAO).

Risk classes:

Class	Buckets	Typical bucket dim
GIRR (interest rate)	5 currencies × 10 tenors	50
CSR (credit spread)	sectors × ratings × tenors	~300
Equity	sectors × cap	13
FX	currency pairs	~150
Commodity	sub-types	11

Toy example (illustrative — full calc has 1000s of buckets):

```
GIRR delta in USD, 5y bucket: WS = 2.5% · DV01_5y × 1e4    (RW 2.5% for USD-5y)
GIRR delta in USD, 10y bucket: WS = 2.4% · DV01_10y × 1e4
Within-currency aggregation: √(WS52 + WS102 + 2·ρ·WS5·WS10)
                                ↑
                                ρ ≈ 0.99 for adjacent tenors

Sum across currencies and add other risk classes for total SBM charge.
```

Canonical Python (single-bucket pattern, scales to all):

```
import numpy as np

def sbm_delta_charge(weighted_sens: np.ndarray, corr_matrix: np.ndarray) -> float:
    """Within-bucket aggregation. weighted_sens shape (n_factors,); corr (n,n)."""
    # FRTB allows negative interior when correlation is negative → take real part of √
    inner = weighted_sens @ corr_matrix @ weighted_sens
    return float(np.sqrt(max(inner, 0)))
```

Intuition / pattern: a giant sensitivity-aggregation tree. Three nested levels: 1. Per-factor risk-weighted sensitivity. 2. Within-bucket aggregation via correlation. 3. Across-bucket aggregation via inter-bucket correlation.

The capital number is **always positive** (variance-style formula) but the per-bucket pre-aggregation can be signed. Banks game this by **concentrating risk where correlations work in their favour** (intra-bucket diversification benefit).

37. FRTB IMA (ES + SES + NMRF)

TL;DR: ES at $\alpha=0.975$ with liquidity-horizon scaling. IMCC + SES (NMRF) + DRC. Most banks dropped IMA for many desks due to operational cost.

What: Internal Models Approach under FRTB. **Replaces VaR with ES at 97.5%** on a stressed period with **liquidity-horizon scaling**, plus SES (Stressed ES at desk level) plus NMRF (Non-Modellable Risk Factor add-on).

How it's calculated:

```
IMCC = ρ · ES_F + (1 - ρ) · ES_RS
    where ES_F = ES on FULL set of modellable factors, scaled by liq-horizon
           ES_RS = ES on REDUCED set (factors with enough data), scaled
           ρ = 0.5 (regulator-fixed)

SES = Σ over each NMRF: stress-scenario loss (similar to historical sVaR per NMRF)

Total IMA charge = IMCC + SES + DRC
```

Liquidity-horizon scaling (FRTB CRE 33.21):

The book has factors at different liquidity horizons $LH_j \in \{10, 20, 40, 60, 120\}$ days. For each LH_j , define S_j = SUBSET of factors with $LH \geq LH_j$ (so S_j shrinks as j grows).

$$ES_{liq}^2 = ES_T(\text{all_factors})^2 + \sum_{\{j \geq 2\}} [ES_T(\text{only_factors_in_}S_j) \cdot \sqrt{(LH_j - LH_{\{j-1\}}) / T}]^2$$

where T = base horizon = 10 days. As LH_j grows, FEWER factors are shocked (only the illiquid ones), so $ES_T(S_j)$ shrinks – the formula adds the incremental risk from holding the less-liquid factors for longer.

Per-factor LH (FRTB): rates / FX (10d), equity vol (20d), small-cap equity (60d), credit IG (40-60d), credit HY (120d).

Formula:

```
IMA = IMCC + SES + DRC
IMCC = 0.5·ES_full_stressed + 0.5·ES_reduced_stressed
SES = Σ NMRF stress_scenario_loss(NMRF)
All ES computed at 97.5% on a stressed window
```

Toy example:

Desk has \$50M of ES at 97.5% on liquid factors. Liquidity-horizon scaling lifts to \$90M. Reduced-set ES = \$75M. $IMCC = 0.5 \cdot 90 + 0.5 \cdot 75 = \$82.5M$. Plus SES for 3 NMRFs at \$5M each = \$15M. Plus DRC = \$20M. Desk IMA capital = $\$82.5 + \$15 + \$20 = \$117.5M$.

Compare to Basel II.5: VaR-based total maybe \$90M. FRTB ~30% higher for the same book.

Canonical Python (high-level scaffold; full implementation is 1000s of lines):

```
import numpy as np

def frtb_ima_charge(es_full: float, es_reduced: float,
                   nmrfs_charges: list[float], drc: float, rho: float = 0.5) -> float:
    imcc = rho * es_full + (1 - rho) * es_reduced
    ses = sum(nmrfs_charges)
    return imcc + ses + drc

def liquidity_horizon_scaling(es_full_t10: float, es_subsets: list[tuple[int, float]],
                             base_horizon_days: int = 10) -> float:
    """FRTB CRE 33.21 LH scaling.
    es_full_t10: ES at base horizon T=10 on the FULL factor set.
    es_subsets: [(LH_j, ES_T(S_j))] for j=2..J – ES computed at base T but on the
                  SUBSET of factors whose LH ≥ LH_j (drop the liquid ones).
    Returns ES_liq under the non-overlapping accumulation rule.
    """
    total_sq = es_full_t10 ** 2
    prev_lh = base_horizon_days
    for lh_j, es_sj in es_subsets:
        weight = ((lh_j - prev_lh) / base_horizon_days) ** 0.5
        total_sq += (es_sj * weight) ** 2
        prev_lh = lh_j
    return float(total_sq ** 0.5)
```

Intuition / pattern: ES at 97.5% is the new VaR at 99% (similar tail mass for Normal: $ES(97.5) \approx VaR(99)$ under Normal P&L). The expensive bits are: 1. **Backtesting at the DESK level** (not just bank) → desks fail → fall back to SA per desk. 2. **NMRF identification** — every factor without 24 obs/year + 100 obs in window is NMRF → punitive SES. 3. **PLA test** (§21) — every desk must pass quarterly or lose IMA eligibility.

Most banks have backed off IMA for many desks because of the operational cost — by far the largest practical impact of FRTB.

38. IRC / DRC (default risk)

TL;DR: Capital for default/migration JUMPS that VaR's Normal misses. 99.9% / 1y. Hammers concentrated single-name positions.

What: capital for default and migration risk on bonds, CDS, single-name credit derivatives. **Outside the VaR framework** because default is a rare-event jump, not a normal-style fluctuation.

IRC (Incremental Risk Charge, Basel II.5):

Defines a 99.9% confidence, 1-year capital charge for default + rating migration on trading-book credit positions. Typically computed via Monte Carlo on a Vasicek-style ASRF model.
Capital = 99.9% VaR of 1-year credit-loss distribution.

DRC (Default Risk Charge, FRTB):

Same idea but redefined: SBM-bucket-by-bucket default risk, with:

- LGD $\in$ {prescribed values per seniority}
- PDs from external ratings, floored
- Hedging recognition only within the same name (not basket)

$$DRC = \sum_{\text{buckets}} \max(\sum_{\text{long}} JTD_w, \sum_{\text{short}} JTD_w \cdot (-\text{recovery}\%))$$

$$JTD_w = \text{jump-to-default weighted exposure}$$

Formula (DRC, sketch):

$$JTD_i = LGD_i \cdot \text{notional}_i - MtM_i$$

$$WtS_i = w_i \cdot JTD_i \quad (\text{risk-weighted})$$

$$\text{Bucket Charge} = \max(\sum \text{longs}, |\sum \text{shorts}|) - \text{hedges}$$

$$DRC = \sum_{\text{buckets}} \text{bucket_charge}$$

Toy example:

\$100M long IG corp bond, LGD 60%, MtM par.
 $JTD = 60\% \cdot 100 - 100 = -40$ (you LOSE 40 if it defaults; netting in cap)
With LGD 60% bonds yielded above par, JTD captures negative carry if recovery > 100-MtM.
DRC charge $\approx \sum$ within bucket of JTDs, no diversification across IG bucket.

Intuition / pattern: default is a jump; VaR's Normal assumption misses it entirely. IRC/DRC adds a one-year, 99.9% charge for **discontinuous credit events**. Strongly punishes concentrated single-name positions (CDS notationals are weighted at full LGD). MBS, CDOs go to a separate charge (CRM, then under FRTB the **securitisation framework**).

39. xVA stack (CVA / DVA / FVA / KVA)

TL;DR: Valuation adjustments to risk-free MtM: counterparty credit (CVA), own credit (DVA), funding (FVA), capital (KVA), margin (MVA). Hedged separately by an XVA desk.

What: valuation adjustments for OTC derivatives. The "risk-free" pricer is wrong — counterparty default risk (CVA), own default (DVA), funding cost (FVA), and capital cost (KVA) each adjust the MtM. Sum forms the **xVA stack**, charged daily and hedged separately.

Definitions:

CVA – Credit Valuation Adjustment

= expected loss from COUNTERPARTY default over life of trade

= $\text{LGD}_{\text{cp}} \cdot \int_0^T \text{EPE}(t) \cdot \text{PD}_{\text{cp}}(t) \cdot \text{DF}(t) dt$

$\text{EPE}(t) = E[\max(V_t - \text{Collateral}_t, 0)]$ (Expected Positive Exposure)

DVA – Debit Valuation Adjustment (the mirror of CVA from the OTHER side)

= $\text{LGD}_{\text{self}} \cdot \int_0^T \text{ENE}(t) \cdot \text{PD}_{\text{self}}(t) \cdot \text{DF}(t) dt$

$\text{ENE}(t) = E[\max(\text{Collateral}_t - V_t, 0)]$ (Expected NEGATIVE Exposure)

Accounting controversy: own-default credit is a "profit" → IFRS 13 requires it but prudential regulators (Basel) exclude it from capital.

FVA – Funding Valuation Adjustment

= cost of funding uncollateralised exposures (between OIS and bank's funding rate)

= $\int_0^T (\text{funding_spread}) \cdot E[\text{Exposure}(t)] \cdot \text{DF}(t) dt$

Hull-White / Burgard-Kjaer FVA framework; charged on uncollateralised legs.

KVA – Capital Valuation Adjustment

= present value of regulatory capital cost (CCR + CVA capital + market risk) over trade life

= $\int_0^T (\text{hurdle_rate} \times \text{required_capital}_t) \cdot \text{DF}(t) dt$

Charged to compensate shareholders for capital tied up by the trade.

MVA – Margin Valuation Adjustment

= cost of posting initial margin under SIMM / CCP rules

= $\int_0^T (\text{margin_funding_spread} \times \text{IM}_t) \cdot \text{DF}(t) dt$

Formula (the stack):

$$V_{\text{xVA}} = V_{\text{risk_free}} - \text{CVA} + \text{DVA} \\ - \text{FVA} - \text{KVA} - \text{MVA}$$

All terms POSITIVE values; signs make the bank's
"fair" price LOWER than risk-free (typically).

Toy example:

10y IRS, $V_{\text{risk free}} = \$500\text{k}$ (in bank's favour).

Counterparty: BB-rated, LGD 60%, peak EPE \$5M, 5% cumulative PD over 10y.

$\text{CVA} \approx 0.60 \cdot \$5\text{M} \cdot 0.05 \cdot 0.80$ (avg DF) = \$120k

Own credit: A-rated, LGD 60%, peak ENE \$0.5M, 1% PD over 10y.

$\text{DVA} \approx 0.60 \cdot \$0.5\text{M} \cdot 0.01 \cdot 0.80$ = \$2.4k

Funding: bank's funding spread 50bp over OIS, avg uncoll exposure \$2M, 10y.

$\text{FVA} \approx 0.0050 \cdot \$2\text{M} \cdot 6$ (PV of annuity) ≈ \$60k

Regulatory capital tied up ~ \$200k initial; hurdle 10%; 10y.

$\text{KVA} \approx 0.10 \cdot \$200\text{k} \cdot 6$ = \$120k

$V_{\text{xVA}} = 500 - 120 + 2.4 - 60 - 120 = \202k (60% reduction from risk-free MtM)

Canonical Python (illustrative — production has thousands of lines per xVA):

```
import numpy as np

def cva(epe_grid: np.ndarray, pd_grid: np.ndarray, df_grid: np.ndarray, lgd: float = 0.6) -> float:
    """Discretised CVA:  $\sum \text{LGD} \cdot \text{EPE}(t_i) \cdot \Delta \text{PD}(t_i) \cdot \text{DF}(t_i)$ ."""
    delta_pd = np.diff(np.concatenate([0], pd_grid))
    return float(lgd * np.sum(epe_grid * delta_pd * df_grid))

def fva(exposure_grid: np.ndarray, funding_spread: float,
        df_grid: np.ndarray, dt: float) -> float:
    """Discretised FVA:  $\sum \text{funding\_spread} \cdot \text{Exposure}(t_i) \cdot \text{DF}(t_i) \cdot dt$ ."""
    return float(funding_spread * np.sum(exposure_grid * df_grid) * dt)
```

Intuition / pattern: xVA is the difference between textbook MtM and what the trade actually nets to the bank. Computed centrally by an **XVA desk** that hedges each component separately: - CVA:

hedged with single-name CDS or index CDS (CDX/iTraxx). - DVA: arguably un-hedgable (banks can't trade their own credit cheaply) — controversial. - FVA: hedged in the bank's funding desk. - KVA: warehoused; charged forward to client.

FRTB-CVA framework (replacing Basel III CVA capital): bank must compute CVA under prescribed risk factors and run the same sensitivity-based aggregation as FRTB SBM (§36) — **CVA becomes part of the market-risk capital number**, not separate.

Sign-trap reminder:

Bank's bid (buyer) price: V_{xVA} from BANK's perspective
 $= V_{riskfree} - CVA + DVA - FVA - KVA$ (bank pays LESS to compensate)
 Bank's ask (seller) price: V_{xVA} from CLIENT's perspective (bank sells at higher to compensate)

Practical: bid-ask spread on derivatives EMBEDS the xVA hedging cost.

Appendix — Coherence axioms (Artzner et al.)

A risk measure $\rho(X)$ (loss-representation: $\rho \geq 0$ is bad) is **coherent** if it satisfies four axioms:

Axiom	Name	What it means
(1)	Monotonicity	$X \leq Y \Rightarrow \rho(X) \geq \rho(Y)$ (a worse loss has higher risk)
(2)	Translation invariance	$\rho(X + c) = \rho(X) - c$ (adding cash reduces risk by same amount)
(3)	Positive homogeneity	$\rho(\lambda \cdot X) = \lambda \cdot \rho(X)$ for $\lambda \geq 0$ (scaling positions scales risk)
(4)	Subadditivity	$\rho(X + Y) \leq \rho(X) + \rho(Y)$ (diversification can only help)

Why it matters:

VaR FAILS (4) in general. Counterexample: two independent low-prob big-loss assets;
individual VaR each = 0, joint VaR > 0.
Implication: VaR can punish diversification – pathological.

ES SATISFIES all 4. This is the formal reason FRTB switched VaR → ES.

Toy counter-example to VaR subadditivity:

Two zero-coupon bonds, each defaults independently with $p = 0.04$, loss = 1.
Individual VaR(0.95) for each = 0 (default prob < $1 - \alpha = 0.05$)
Combined: $P(\text{both default}) = 0.0016$, $P(\text{at least one default}) = 0.0784 > 0.05$
→ Combined VaR(0.95) = 1 > sum of individual VaRs = 0
→ Diversification "increased" VaR by the metric. VaR violates subadditivity. ✗

ES gives a coherent answer that does NOT punish this diversification.

Practical takeaway: prefer ES for capital, prefer VaR for limits. Limits desks want a metric that doesn't move under intraday rebalancing (VaR's discreteness helps); capital wants a number that diversifies sensibly (ES's coherence helps).

Risk-factor sign cheatsheet

Reference for the daily explain. Under the convention $s = V(\text{bumped}) - V(\text{base})$ used throughout this document:

Long position in...	DV01	CS01	IE01	FX-Δ	Vega
Vanilla bond	–	–	0	0	0
Linker	–	0	+	0	0
Foreign bond	–	–	0	+	0
FRN	≈0 (between resets)	–	0	0	0
IRS receive-fixed	–	0	0	0	0
IRS pay-fixed	+	0	0	0	0
ZCIS receive-inflation	≈0 at par	0	+	0	0
FX Spot / Fwd (long foreign)	+ (small)	0	0	+	0
CDS protection BUYER	– (small)	+	0	0	0
CDS protection SELLER	+ (small)	–	0	0	0
Long call (FX, swaption)	small	0	0	+Δ	+
Long put	small	0	0	–Δ	+
Pension annuity liability (short)	+	0	–	0	0

Convention swap (vendor systems): Bloomberg / most risk systems report DV01 as **loss-given-up** (positive for long bonds). For those numbers, **flip every sign in the DV01 column above**.

Greeks aggregation rule: per-instrument Greeks **add linearly** when factors are common. So a portfolio's total DV01 = $\sum$ instrument DV01; total vega = $\sum$ instrument vega (only on instruments sharing the same vol surface).